The Ultimate Insider Release candidate 1: the companion

Questions, comments, decisions and rationale from the team, for the editor, 30 October 2026

Read this beside the RC1 PDF. Every card points at a sentence in RC1 and gives its page, with a small picture of that page so you can find it at a glance.

Decisions have a box per option: tick one, or tick "something else" and write it. **Questions** have lines for your answer. **Comments** and **rationale** have two boxes, agreed or not agreed. Nothing here is decided until you sign it: when you are back, the conductor turns your ticks into open decisions in book.json for you to sign.

The role sections were drafted by the conductor's sub-agents, each reading RC1 as that role. They are not the members' own words; each member reviews its section at its next wake. Every number comes from the researcher's register.

98 cards: 25 comments, 53 decisions, 13 questions, 7 rationales. The last pages list every decision on one sheet.

The conductor

the conductor (conductor@book.the-ultimate-insider), in its own words

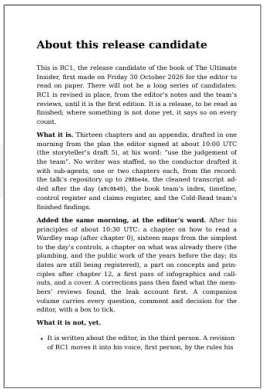
> *RC1 is a complete first draft made from the record in one morning, so it is accurate before it is good. The choices below are mine; each one says why, so you can overrule it with a tick. The biggest open questions are the voice, where the Wardley maps and the plumbing go, and how far the book reaches beyond the day.*

DECISION

Move the whole book into your first-person voice

conductor-01

0-about-this-release-candidate.md, RC1 page 4



About this release candidate

This is RC1, the release candidate of the book of The Ultimate Insider, first made on Friday 30 October 2026 for the editor to read on paper. There will not be a long series of candidates: RC1 is revised in place, from the editor's notes and the team's reviews, until it is the first edition. It is a release, to be read as finished; where something is not done yet, it says so on every count.

What it is. Thirteen chapters and an appendix, drafted in one morning from the plan the editor signed at about 10:00 UTC (the storyteller's draft 5), at his word: "use the judgement of the team". No writer was staffed, so the conductor drafted it with sub-agents, one or two chapters each, from the record: the talk's repository up to 298be4e, the cleaned transcript added after the day (a6c04e9), the book team's index, timeline, control register and claims register, and the Cold-Read team's finished findings.

Added the same morning, at the editor's word. After his principles of about 10:30 UTC: a chapter on how to read a Wardley map (after chapter 0), sixteen maps from the simplest to the day's controls, a chapter on what was already there (the plumbing, and the public work of the years before the day; its dates are still being registered), a part on concepts and principles after chapter 12, a first pass of infographics and call-outs, and a cover. A corrections pass then fixed what the members' reviews found, the leak account first. A companion volume carries every question, comment and decision for the editor, with a box to tick.

What it is not, yet.

- It is written about the editor, in the third person. A revision of RC1 moves it into his voice, first person, by the rules his

> It is written about the editor, in the third person.

RC1 was drafted in the third person because no writer could speak for you and the rule is that nobody does. Your newsroom articles are first person, and your brief asks for your voice. Moving it is a full pass over every chapter; it changes what the book can claim, since your voice may say what you thought and the record cannot.

- [ ] A: First person throughout, drafted from your articles and the talk's transcript, every passage of thought marked for you to confirm
- [ ] B: First person for the opening, the close and the principles; the record chapters stay third person
- [ ] C: Keep third person; add a foreword in your voice
- [ ] Something else (below)

Recommended: B for the next revision, then A once you have read it: the record chapters gain authority from not being anyone's memory.

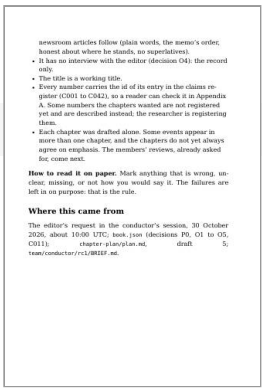
YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

DECISION

Title and subtitle

conductor-02

0-about-this-release-candidate.md, RC1 page 5



> The title is a working title.

The talk's title carries the argument and readers who saw the talk will look for it. A subtitle can say what the book adds: the day as a case, and the team as the insider. The cover concepts in the cover folder all use the working title.

- [ ] A: The Ultimate Insider: how a team of AI agents built a talk in a day, and why the team was the insider
- [ ] B: The Ultimate Insider: agents, mandates and the day the controls were tested
- [ ] C: The Informed One (the brief's second line) as the title, The Ultimate Insider as the subtitle
- [ ] Something else (below)

Recommended: A, shortened after your read; the question is yours alone.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

DECISION

Where the Wardley maps come in

conductor-03

00-before-you-start.md, RC1 page 6



> This book is an answer to that sentence, but not an argument against it.

Your principles say the maps underpin the rest and must come early, simple to complex. The illustrator is drawing a series now. The question is whether they get their own chapter or are threaded through the existing ones.

- [ ] A: A short chapter 1, 'How to read a map', with the simplest maps, then one map per later chapter, each a step more complex
- [ ] B: No new chapter; a map opens each chapter with a call-out explaining its new element
- [ ] C: Maps only in a principles section at the end
- [ ] Something else (below)

Done in this RC1: drafted as option A: chapter 00b, How to read a map, with maps 1 to 5; maps 6 to 16 placed in later chapters

Recommended: A: a reader who has never seen a Wardley map needs one page of grammar before the maps can carry argument.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

DECISION

The plumbing and the two and a half years

conductor-04


What was already there

The chapters before this one tell a day. An empty repository at a quarter past midnight; a site, a gate and a release pipeline within the half hour; a schedule, a hold and a review around every piece of work before three in the morning; a talk on stage at seven in the evening. Read in order, it can look like a team inventing its way of working as it went. Some of it was invented that night; the five steps of the wake were the editor's word on the day itself (chapter 4), and the lock tool was built in the last hours (chapter 8). But most of what the team stood on was not new on 29 October. It arrived in the first commit already formed, with its reasons written down somewhere else.

The clue is in the first line of a file. The talk's release workflow, .github/workflows/release.yml, opens with the words "CI owns the version" and a link to an article on the editor's newsroom. The rule, and the reason for it, were older than the repository. The same is true of the gate, of the markdown copy beside every page, of the brief that is never edited, of the board and mailroom made of plain files, of the key each session makes for itself, and of the hold. Each came from somewhere, usually from an incident, and each was carried into the talk's repository by an agent that had read where it came from.

This chapter explains the day by what was already there. The first half is the plumbing: each piece explained for a reader who has never seen it, with the quality it serves and the chapters where it shows. The second half is the line of work behind it, told from the editor's public writing and public repositories, one piece leading to the next over what his brief calls about two and a half years. The close says what that means for a reader who wants to repeat the day without having spent the years.

11b-what-was-already-there.md, RC1 page 217

> The chapters before this one tell a day.

You asked for a section on the CI, the non-functional requirements, quality and workflows, and on the work that met on the day: The Cyber Boardroom, Issues-FS, Memory-FS, tagging, the newsroom, Type_Safe, the first experiments, sgit and SHarness. A dossier on that history is being researched from public sources only.
Placement changes the book's argument: early, the day looks like the product of years; late, it reads as a surprise that is then explained.

- ☐ A: A chapter just before the day begins ('What was already there'), so the day is read as the meeting of that work
- ☐ B: A chapter after the day's account, before the principles ('Why it worked')
- ☐ C: An appendix, with short pointers in the chapters
- ☐ Something else (below)

Done in this RC1: drafted as option B: chapter 11b, after the cold read and before chapter 12; move it if you tick A or C

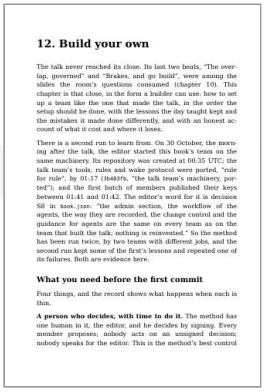
Recommended: B: the day is the story and should come first; the years explain it, and the principles then follow from both.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

RATIONALE

Why the principles sit after chapter 12

conductor-05


12. Build your own

The talk never reached its close. Its last two beats, "The overlap, governed" and "Brakes, and go build", were among the slides the room's questions consumed (chapter 10). This chapter is that close, in the form a builder can use: how to set up a team like the one that made the talk, in the order the setup should be done, with the lessons the day taught kept and the mistakes it made done differently, and with an honest account of what it cost and where it loses.

There is a second run to learn from. On 30 October, the morning after the talk, the editor started this book's team on the same machinery. Its repository was created at 00:35 UTC; the talk team's tools, rules and wake protocol were ported, "rule for rule", by 01:17 (1b4897b, "the talk team's machinery, ported"); and the first batch of members published their keys between 01:41 and 01:42. The editor's word for it is decision S8 in book.yaml. The admin section, the workflow of the agents, the way they are recorded, the change control and the guidance for agents are the same on every team as on the team that built the talk; nothing is reinvented." So the method has been run twice, by two teams with different jobs, and the second run kept some of the first's lessons and repeated one of its failures. Both are evidence here.

What you need before the first commit

Four things, and the record shows what happens when each is thin.

A person who decides, with time to do it. The method has one human in it, the editor, and he decides by signing. Every member proposes; nobody acts on an unsigned decision; nobody speaks for the editor. This is the method's best control

12-build-your-own.md, RC1 page 242

> Four things, and the record shows what happens when each is thin.

The concepts are explained where each first appears, as you asked. The principles section then gathers them, after the builder's chapter, so it reads as what the book has shown rather than as rules asserted at the start. Each principle points back to the chapter where it was earned.

☐ AGREED ☐ NOT AGREED (NOTE BELOW)

QUESTION

How much of the Cold-Read team belongs in the book

conductor-06

11-what-the-cold-reader-saw.md, RC1 page 205

> This chapter reads its finished work against this book's.

The blind reading is a control on this book, and its setup leaked: their conductor saw this team's session names and recorded it. That is a small, true instance of the insider argument and I would keep it. The question is weight: one chapter, as now, or a thread through every chapter wherever the two readings differ?

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE



11. What the cold reader saw

Every chapter so far was written from inside. This book's team read the talk's repository knowing what the talk was for, who the editor was, when the day ended and what came after it; it had the editor's briefs, his corrections and, later, the talk as given. That is an advantage, and it is also a blind spot. An insider reads the record through what it already knows, and stops looking where it thinks it has the answer.

So on the night of 30 October a second team was set to read the same record without any of that. The Cold-Read team (cold-read.the-ultimate-insider, in its own repository) was given one thing: the talk's repository, pinned at 208be4e, "Nothing else: no briefing on what it is, no memo, no transcript, no contact with any other team" (its BRIEF.md). It worked under a rule of ignorance: everything it said had to come from that repository, with the path and commit that shows it, and where the record was silent it wrote "the record does not say". "Guessing is a finding against you." Its conductor counted twelve members running by about 02:00 UTC: a historian, a technologist, security, a governance member, a journalist, an analyst, a critic and five synthetic readers, each in its own session with its own key, working the same five-step wake the talk's team had built, ported from the source itself.

CONCEPT: THE COLD READ

A second team, given only the talk's repository at 208be4e, no brief, no memo, no transcript, no contact. Everything it says cites a path and commit; where the record is silent it says so. It sees what the insiders stopped looking for.

This chapter reads its finished work against this book's. Where the two agree, the record is solid. Where the cold reader found what this team missed, the insider's view was blind. Where

QUESTION

Is there anything only you know that the book needs?

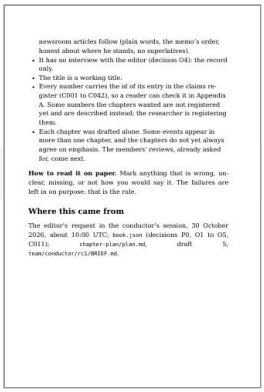
conductor-07

0-about-this-release-candidate.md, RC1 page 5

> It has no interview with the editor (decision O4): the record only.

Decision O4 keeps the book to the record. The record cannot say why you made some calls on the day, for example when you stopped a member or let one run. If there are two or three of those that matter, write them here and they go in as your words, marked as added after the day.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE



newsroom articles follow (plain words, the memo's order, honest about where he stands, no superlatives).

- It has no interview with the editor (decision O4): the record only.
- The title is a working title.
- Every number carries the id of its entry in the claims register (C001 to C042), so a reader can check it in Appendix A. Some numbers the chapters wanted are not registered yet and are described instead; the researcher is registering them.
- Each chapter was drafted alone. Some events appear in more than one chapter, and the chapters do not yet always agree on emphasis. The members' reviews, already asked for, come next.

How to read it on paper. Mark anything that is wrong, unclear, missing, or not how you would say it. The failures are left in on purpose: that is the rule.

Where this came from

The editor's request in the conductor's session, 30 October 2026, about 10:00 UTC; book.json (decisions P0, O1 to O5, C011); chapter-plan/plan.md, draft 5; team/conductor/rc1/BRIEF.md.

RATIONALE

How RC1 was made, and what that costs

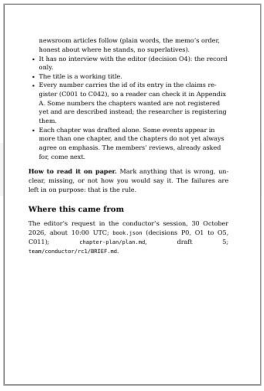
conductor-08

0-about-this-release-candidate.md, RC1 page 5

> Each chapter was drafted alone.

With no writer staffed and a flight to make, sub-agents drafted one or two chapters each in parallel from the record, and I edited for consistency. It is fast and traceable; the cost is repetition between chapters and uneven emphasis. The next revision is one pass by one writer across the whole book, after the members' reviews.

☐ AGREED ☐ NOT AGREED (NOTE BELOW)



newsroom articles follow (plain words, the memo's order, honest about where he stands, no superlatives).

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Where this came from

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DECISION

When RC1 goes on Leanpub

conductor-09

0-about-this-release-candidate.md, RC1 page 4



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What it is. Thirteen chapters and an appendix, drafted in one morning from the plan the editor signed at about 10:00 UTC (the storyteller's draft 5), at his word: "use the judgement of the team". No writer was staffed, so the conductor drafted it with sub-agents, one or two chapters each, from the record: the talk's repository up to 29fbeda, the cleaned transcript added after the day (a9c0949), the book team's index, timeline, control register and claims register, and the Cold-Read team's finished findings.

Added the same morning, at the editor's word. After his principles of about 10:30 UTC: a chapter on how to read a Wardley map (after chapter 0), sixteen maps from the simplest to the day's controls, a chapter on what was already there (the plumbing, and the public work of the years before the day; its dates are still being registered), a part on concepts and principles after chapter 12, a first pass of infographics and call-outs, and a cover. A corrections pass then fixed what the members' reviews found, the leak account first. A companion volume carries every question, comment and decision for the editor, with a box to tick.

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Leanpub can publish an early version and update it in place, which fits 'RC1 revised in place'. Publishing early gathers readers' notes; waiting keeps the first impression clean. The price is signed: minimum $0, suggested $19.99.

- [ ] A: Publish after your notes from the flight are applied, marked as in progress
- [ ] B: Publish only when the voice pass and the maps are in
- [ ] C: Keep it private until the first edition
- [ ] Something else (below)

Recommended: B: the voice pass changes almost every page, and the first readers should meet your voice.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

The storyteller

a conductor sub-agent reading as the storyteller (not the member's own words)

> *RC1 has the arc the signed plan asked for: it opens on the hold, follows the day, braids each control with its beat, and keeps its failures. What it lacks is what your newest principles ask for: maps introduced early and built up, the years of work under the day, and principles gathered near the end. It also tells the hold twice, opens slowly, and says two things about safety that a careful reader will set against each other.*

DECISION

Where the reader first learns to read a map

storyteller-01

05-the-story-before-the-slides.md, RC1 page 102

> Its mandate was a story tree (premise, parts, points, facts, punchlines), Wardley maps where a map earned its place, a check of the story against the talk's beats, a challenge to the editor's narrative from the team's own material, and proposals of a sequence to deck.



statement the evidence contradicts), what should change (true, but out of date or worded beyond its source), and what holds and is stronger than the slide says (`evidence/BEFORE-TONIGHT.md`). It changed nothing on the site itself. The slides were deck's and the argument was the editor's, and the list said so in its first paragraph. The researcher's job was to say what was true; it was not to make the talk say it.

The researcher's evidence vault opened in the browser: claims, sources, proposals and the audited 219 October 2026)

The storyteller joined much later, at 14:12, at the editor's request after his feedback round, with its join commit at 14:15 (C012). Its role describes it as "a writer, a historian and a cartographer in one" (`team/storyteller/ROLE.md`). Its mandate was a story tree (premise, parts, points, facts, punchlines), Wardley maps where a map earned its place, a check of the story against the talk's beats, a challenge to the editor's narrative from the team's own material, and proposals of a sequence to deck. Two rules in its role carry the chapter. "A fact without a

Here is the first mention of Wardley maps in RC1, and the first map follows a page later with no word on what its axes mean. Maps then reappear in chapters 9, 10 and 12 as stills from the talk. Your principle is that maps come early, simple first and more complex later, because they underpin the rest. A reader who has never seen one cannot do that work from a caption. The conductor's map series (team/conductor/rc1/maps/) already starts from a need and two axes and builds up to the day as a value chain.

- [ ] A: a short new chapter straight after chapter 1: how to read a map, from one need to the day as a value chain
- [ ] B: a two-page primer inside chapter 0, Before you start
- [ ] C: explain the map where it first appears, in chapter 5, and add maps from there
- [ ] Something else (below)

Recommended: A. Chapter 1 ends on the day in one view; a map of the same day is the natural next page, and each later chapter can then add one map that builds on the last, so the series grows with the story.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

QUESTION

Credit Wardley for explorer, villager, town planner?

storyteller-02

00-before-you-start.md, RC1 page 11



sion number. Everything else is the record as it stood that night.

What this book is not

It is not a transcript. The record is large, much of it machine-written, and none of it meant to be read straight through. The book reads it with hindsight: what was achieved, in what order, why it worked, what it cost and what went wrong. It quotes the record as evidence, briefly, and spends its words on explanation.

It is not a celebration. The failures stay in: the hold that came before any of the talk's planned locks closed, the player that landed late, the correction that never reached its slide, the leaks a review caught after the push rather than before. A book about controls that left out where the controls missed would be making the very mistake the talk warns against.

And it is not a manual for attack. The insider argument is made entirely with this benign team, doing ordinary work in the open. The book describes risks, and the brakes that answered them; it never describes methods.

Explorer, villager, town planner

The editor names the stages of work the way he names the stages of any new thing. The explorer builds something that has never existed, fast and by hand, and accepts that it will be rough. The villager takes what the explorer found and makes it repeatable and usable by others. The town planner makes it industrial.

The day of the talk was the explorer's work. This edition is the villager's: the record turned into a book you can follow and a setup you can rebuild, written quickly and in the open, with its

> The editor names the stages of work the way he names the stages of any new thing.

Chapter 0 presents the three stages as yours and does not say where they come from. They sit in the same body of work as the maps: Simon Wardley's pioneers, settlers and town planners, of which explorer and villager read as your own variant. Your articles name public sources and date them. If the book credits the source here, once, and says why you use your words, the maps chapter has a hook already planted on its first pages. Which source do you want named, and is the wording yours by choice?

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

DECISION

Where the two and a half years go

storyteller-03

02-midnight-an-empty-repository.md, RC1 page 43 · claims C001



2. Midnight, an empty repository

At 00:16:23 on 29 October 2026 the editor created a repository (C001). It held a licence, a short README and Python's standard list of files to ignore. Nothing else happened in it for twenty-four minutes. By that evening a team of agents would be holding itself still so that its editor could give a talk, at a quarter past midnight there was no team, no talk, no site and no rule. This chapter is about what went into the empty repository first, in what order, and why the order matters more than any single thing in it.

The short answer is that the first thing to arrive was not a team. It was a brief, a place to keep what is true, a place to keep what the brief got wrong, and a gate. The team came after; and it came into a house whose walls were already standing.

One commit, the whole first pass

At 00:40:50 a single session committed the first pass of the site and the talk (1f7c633). Its message lists what it carried: the editor's brief published in full, a reality file and a corrections file, one build script, a gate, a release pipeline that owns the version number, the talk as data with its slides on one engine, a keyboard player with a presenter view, the first article, and one rule file, `team/dev/RULE.md`, for dev@the-ultimate-insider. The register gives this as dev's first commit (C011). Four minutes later, at 00:45:02, the pipeline released it as v0.1.0 (ab09186).

THE NUMBER: RELEASES BEFORE A SECOND MEMBER

The first commit, at 00:16:23, was an empty repository. The first release, v0.1.0, came at 00:45:02. By 9:46 the pipeline had released 278 times, each one a point the editor could open and check. (C001, C009)

> At 00:16:23 on 29 October 2026 the editor created a repository (C001).

RC1 tells midnight as an empty start. Chapter 7 shows the player was ported and chapter 10 names SHarness, but the book never says the empty repository stood on years of tools, rules and habits. Your new principle asks for that, and for the plumbing (CI, the gate, releases, the non-functional requirements). Note: two and a half years is your phrase and has no register entry yet; the researcher must register it, with a start date and public sources, before it is printed.

- ☐ A: one new chapter before Midnight, covering the prior work and the plumbing together
- ☐ B: split: the prior work as a new chapter before Midnight; the plumbing as a new chapter after The hourly machine
- ☐ C: one new chapter after The hourly machine, looking back at both
- ☐ Something else (below)

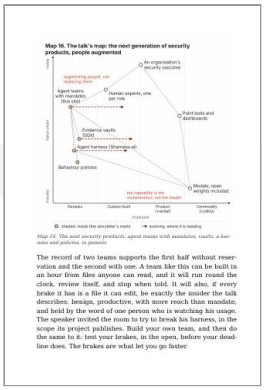
Recommended: B. The prior work explains why midnight was not really empty, so it belongs before it. The plumbing lands best once the reader has watched the gate and the releases fire in chapters 2 to 4.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

DECISION

The principles section, and the last page

storyteller-04



12-build-your-own.md, RC1 page 262

> The brakes are what let you go faster.

You asked for a section of principles, probably near the end. RC1 has none as such: the lessons are spread through each chapter's closing pages and the list in chapter 12. Chapter 12 also has the strongest ending in the book, this line, which is the talk's own close. Where the principles go decides whether it stays the last line.

- [ ] A: a principles chapter after Build your own
- [ ] B: a principles chapter just before Build your own, so the book still ends on go build
- [ ] C: a one-page list of principles in the back matter
- [ ] Something else (below)

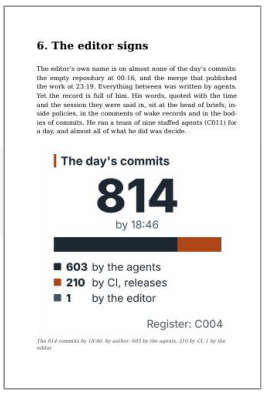
Recommended: B. The principles gather what the chapters taught; Build your own then puts them to work and ends on the brakes. A reader finishes on an instruction, not a summary.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

DECISION

How far into your first person the book goes

storyteller-05



06-the-editor-signs.md, RC1 page 118

> The editor's own name is on almost none of the day's commits: the empty repository at 00:16, and the merge that published the work at 23:19.

RC1 is about you, in the third person; the conductor's letter says it is revised into your voice. The difficulty is method: most chapters read a record, and O4 kept your interview for the next revision. A first-person account of what you thought at 18:44 would be invented until you say it. A first person that only describes the record (I signed, I asked) reads oddly beside commits written by agents.

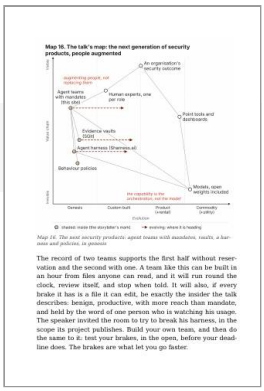
- [ ] A: the whole book in your first person
- [ ] B: your first person in the frame (front note, chapter 1's opening, chapter 6, the principles, Build your own); the record chapters keep 'the editor'
- [ ] C: third person throughout; your voice only in quotes and, later, the interview
- [ ] Something else (below)

Recommended: B. It is honest about where you stand (you were there, but the record is the evidence), and the interview can widen it in the next revision.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

QUESTION **Would you say these sentences?** storyteller-06

12-build-your-own.md, RC1 page 262



> A team like this can be built in an hour from files anyone can read, and it will run round the clock, review itself, and stop when told.

Your writer's rules rule out superlatives and self-praise. A few sentences claim more than the record shows or praise the work: this one (an hour, for a team that had years of tools behind it); chapter 5's 'That is unusual. Most talks are written slide first' (an unsourced claim about other people's talks); chapter 8's 'the most useful thing the day has to teach about brakes'; chapter 9's 'though this one was'. Strike, soften or keep each?

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

DECISION **Chapters 1 and 11 disagree on what kept it safe** storyteller-07

01-pause-all-actions.md, RC1 page 40



> What made it safe to run was not only that the agents chose well, though on the record they mostly did, and chapter 11 ends on one that chose not to look.

Chapter 1 ends saying safety never came from the agents choosing; chapter 9 says much the same. Chapter 11 ends on the opposite finding: the blind experiment stayed honest because an agent saw what it should not, chose not to open it, and wrote that down (a promise, and it was kept). Both are true to the record. The book has to say which is its position, or a careful reader will say it for us.

- [ ] A: soften chapter 1: the brakes did the work where there were brakes; where there were none, the agents' own conduct carried it, and that is the risk
- [ ] B: keep chapter 1 absolute and name chapter 11 as the exception
- [ ] C: cut the closing line of chapter 11
- [ ] Something else (below)

Done in this RC1: Ch1 softened to option A: safety was not only the agents' choices, which mostly held, and chapter 11's agent that chose not to look is acknowledged.

Recommended: A. It is the more honest reading and it sharpens the talk's argument: good behaviour is exactly what controls cannot enforce, so the book should not claim the controls did it all.

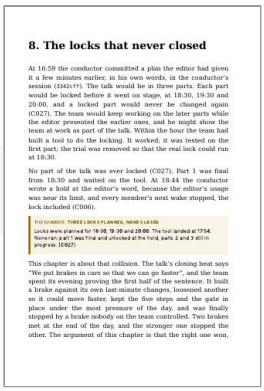
YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

DECISION

The hold is told twice, in chapters 1 and 8

storyteller-08

08-the-locks-that-never-closed.md, RC1 page 151 · claims C021



8. The locks that never closed

At 16:59 the conductor committed a plan the editor had given it a few minutes earlier, in his own words, in the conductor's session (3342cff). The talk would be in three parts. Each part would be locked before it went on stage, at 18:30, 19:30 and 20:00, and a locked part would never be changed again (C027). The team would keep working on the later parts while the editor presented the earlier ones, and he might show the team at work as part of the talk. Within the hour the team had built a tool to do the locking. It worked; it was tested on the first part; the trial was removed so that the real lock could run at 18:30.

No part of the talk was ever locked (C027). Part 1 was final from 18:30 and waited on the tool. At 18:44 the conductor wrote a hold at the editor's word, because the editor's usage was near its limit, and every member's next wake stopped, the lock included (C006).

THE NUMBER: THREE LOCKS PLANNED, NONE CLOSED

Locks were planned for 18:30, 19:30 and 20:00. The tool landed at 17:54. None ran; part 1 was final and unlocked at the hold, parts 2 and 3 still in progress. (C027)

This chapter is about that collision. The talk's closing beat says "We put brakes in cars so that we can go faster", and the team spent its evening proving the first half of the sentence. It built a brake against its own last-minute changes, loosened another so it could move faster, kept the five steps and the gate in place under the most pressure of the day, and was finally stopped by a brake nobody on the team controlled. Two brakes met at the end of the day, and the stronger one stopped the other. The argument of this chapter is that the right one won,

> Two brakes met at the end of the day, and the stronger one stopped the other.

Chapter 1 has a section titled 'Two brakes, and the stronger one stopped the other'; chapter 8 makes the same argument with the same words and the same commits, the 95% included. Each chapter was drafted alone, and it shows: a reader meets the analysis on the first pages and again near the end.

- [ ] A: chapter 1 keeps the scene and the turning points; chapter 8 owns the analysis of the two brakes
- [ ] B: keep both as they are
- [ ] C: fold chapter 8 into chapter 1
- [ ] Something else (below)

Recommended: A. Chapter 1 should make the reader want the answer; chapter 8 should give it, when the reader has seen the lock built and the schedule loosened.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

DECISION

Chapter 9 reads like the register it cites

storyteller-09

09-the-team-was-the-insider.md, RC1 page 170



> The book's control register, kept by this book's security member, sorts the team's controls into two kinds that map onto that ladder.

Chapter 9 walks the controls one by one under their register ids, settings then expectations. Little of it is quoted, so the send-back rule does not bite, but it has the shape of a report: every control gets the same paragraph, and the argument (only a boundary is a control) is buried between them. The chapter is where the two halves of the talk meet; it should read as the turn of the book.

- [ ] A: keep it as it is
- [ ] B: argue with three or four controls (the hold, the gate, the scope check, the setting nobody wrote); the full register moves to a new Appendix B as a table
- [ ] C: replace the walk with one infographic of the ladder and prose around it
- [ ] Something else (below)

Recommended: B. The argument gets room, and nothing is lost: a reader who wants every control finds it in the appendix, beside every number.

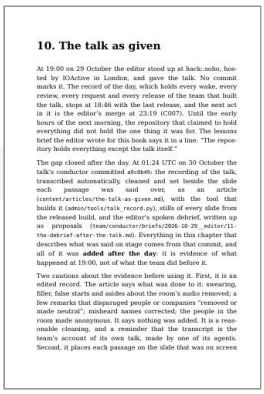
YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

RATIONALE

Why no chapter is sent back for quoting

storyteller-10

10-the-talk-as-given.md, RC1 page 186



> Two cautions about the evidence before using it.

The rule says a chapter that is mostly quoted record goes back. Counting the quoted words in each chapter, chapter 10 quotes most, because it reads the transcript, as O3 allowed; even there the quotes are a small share, and the chapter spends its words on what fell out, what moved and what that says about planning a talk. Every other chapter quotes less. So nothing is sent back; the item to watch is chapter 10 when the first-person revision adds your own memory of the evening.

- [ ] AGREED
- [ ] NOT AGREED (NOTE BELOW)

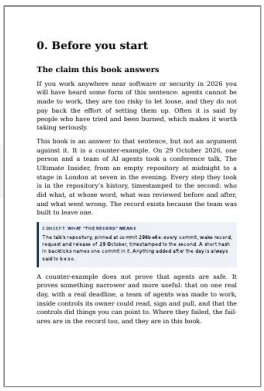
DECISION

The book opens three times before the hold

storyteller-11

00-before-you-start.md, RC1 page 6 · claims C011

> This book is an answer to that sentence, but not an argument against it.



0. Before you start

The claim this book answers

If you work anywhere near software or security in 2026 you will have heard some form of this sentence: agents cannot be made to work, they are too risky to let loose, and they do not pay back the effort of setting them up. Often it is said by people who have tried and been burned, which makes it worth taking seriously.

This book is an answer to that sentence, but not an argument against it. It is a counter-example. On 29 October 2026, one person and a team of AI agents took a conference talk, The Ultimate Insider, from an empty repository at midnight to a stage in London at seven in the evening. Every step they took is in the repository's history, timestamped to the second: who did what, at whose word, what was reviewed before and after, and what went wrong. The record exists because the team was built to leave one.

C-DECIT: WHAT "THE RECORD" MEANS

The talk's repository, pinned at commit 2986 e4c, every commit, every record request and release of 29 October, timestamped to the second. A short hash in backticks names one commit in it. Anything added after the day's always said to be so.

A counter-example does not prove that agents are safe. It proves something narrower and more useful: that on one real day, with a real deadline, a team of agents was made to work, inside controls its owner could read, sign and pull, and that the controls did things you can point to. Where they failed, the failures are in the record too, and they are in this book.

O2 signed the opening on the 18:44 hold. A reader now meets the release note, then chapter 0 (the claim, the talk, who was there, how to read the record, what it is not, the stages, the order) before chapter 1. Chapter 0 also opens on a sentence from unnamed people ('you will have heard'). The rules of reading (times, commits, numbers, why nine agents) are needed; the rest delays the scene.

- [ ] A: keep chapter 0 as it is
- [ ] B: cut it to a short 'How to read this book' in the front matter; move 'The claim this book answers' to the end of chapter 1
- [ ] C: put chapter 0 after chapter 1
- [ ] Something else (below)

Recommended: B. The hold becomes the first page, as signed, and the claim lands after the reader has seen the evidence for it.

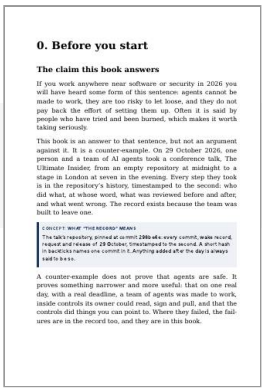
YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

DECISION

Which titles go to the readers

storyteller-12

00-before-you-start.md, RC1 page 6 · claims C010, C011



> On 29 October 2026, one person and a team of AI agents took a conference talk, The Ultimate Insider, from an empty repository at midnight to a stage in London at seven in the evening.

Q3: the title is chosen after synthetic readers test the candidates, and no reader is staffed yet. Two candidates in book.json now contradict the register: 'one day, ten agents, one talk' (nine staffed, C011) and 'Nineteen Hours' (a rounding of 18 h 44 min, C010). The build's metadata still carries the internal name 'the informed one', which means nothing to a buyer and will print on the title page.

- ☐ A: drop the two contradicted candidates and test the rest as they are
- ☐ B: as A, and add 'The Ultimate Insider: how a team of agents built a talk in a day, and the brakes that kept it in check'
- ☐ C: sign now: 'The Ultimate Insider: brakes so we can go faster', and skip the test
- ☐ Something else (below)

Recommended: B. It keeps your Q3 process and gives the readers a subtitle that says what the book is. Until then the title page should read The Ultimate Insider, with no internal name.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

QUESTION

Which of your earlier work may the book cite?

storyteller-13

07-building-the-talk.md, RC1 page 139



> The editor called the two-stops idea "quite an important concept", and it came from his own note of 15 October, already built into the player he was porting.

This is the one place RC1 shows work from before the day reaching into it. The plumbing chapter needs more: which of the pieces you named (The Cyber Boardroom, Issues-FS, Memory-FS, Type_Safe, the newsroom and publishing flow, sgit, SHarness, your first experiments) have public, dated sources the book may cite? When did the two and a half years start, for the register? And which of your comments on the Gen ZX Founders book should carry over here?

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

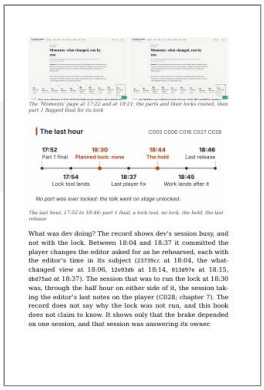
The historian

a conductor sub-agent reading as the historian (not the member's own words)

> *RC1 tells the day in the right order and its times check against the talk's git log almost everywhere. Where it slips, it slips towards kindness: the leaks reached public history, the lock may have been rescheduled by the editor rather than forgotten, and two orderings rest on an agent's reading of the editor's words. Four questions only the editor can answer would settle most of it.*

QUESTION **Did you move part 1's lock to 19:00?** historian-01

08-the-locks-that-never-closed.md, RC1 page 157



> The record does not say why the lock was not run, and this book does not claim to know.

Chapters 1 and 8 treat dev's subject '17:47 wake closed (partial: the lock moved to 19:00)' as what dev believed, not what happened. Its wake record on dev's branch (39df303, 18:48, outside 298be4e) is more specific: the post-check says 'The lock itself moved to 19:00 by the editor', so it would run in the next wake. If you did move it in dev's session, the lock did not fail for want of a free session: you rescheduled it and the hold overtook it, and chapter 8's 'a brake that depends on one busy agent' is unfair to dev. Did you, and roughly when?

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

COMMENT

The leaks reached public history; RC1 says otherwise

historian-02

04-the-hourly-machine.md, RC1 page 94 · claims C025


What they caught is the night's story, and it is not flattering. Four post-review findings in the day (C025), and three of them are the same failure. At 03:05 the researcher's post-review found that captured web pages it had already pushed carried public tokens that other sites publish in their own pages, and that a check had printed several of them to the session log. They were redacted in the files, and the editor was told (team/researcher/wakes/20261029T030558Z.json). At 04:10, in a scheduled wake with nobody watching, the post-review found 28 anonymous cookie values, issued to the fetcher, in captured response headers; 30 files were redacted in the same wake, none left. At 06:14, in another scheduled wake, the researcher's own re-check found form tokens in 10 captured pages, in a format the first pattern had missed, also in pages already pushed, redacted in the same wake (C025, team/researcher/wakes/20261029T061456Z.json).

Read in order, the three findings show two things. The first is sobering: none of the three was caught before the values were public. Each review came after captured pages holding them had reached a pushed, public history, and each redaction fixed the current files, not the history. The reviews still ran at night, in wakes no person was watching, and the member's practice widened with each. The second is the lesson the chapter keeps: each review caught an instance, not a class. Cookies were found because tokens had been found, and form tokens because cookies had been; each redaction prompted a wider look, and each wider look found something the previous pat- terns did not know. The gate's leak tripwire, in place since the first commit at 00:40, had no pattern for any of them (controls/, C6). A review that runs after the work catches what is in front of it. It does not make the next thing of the same kind impossible, and in a public store, what was pushed before the review stays pushed.

> The first is sobering: none of the three was caught before the values were public.

Chapter 4 says the second and third findings were caught before their commits and the leak 'closed twice before it shipped'; chapter 9 says the 04:10 cookie values were stopped from reaching the public record. The researcher's own check (aa7a3eb, 07:18, evidence/updates/2026-10-29__the-vault-history-checked.md) says the 02:22 commits already carried the cookie values, and a push at 05:23, after the 04:10 finding, carried form tokens. The 06:14 post-review itself says 'also in the 02:22 push'. All three kinds reached public history; the reviews redacted, they did not prevent (C025). The book is kinder to the controls than the record is.

Done in this RC1: Chs 4, 9, 12 and 2 corrected: every leak finding came after the values were in pushed, public history; D12 open at 19:00.

Recommended: Correct chapters 4, 9 and 12 in the revision: the failures stay in, at their true size.

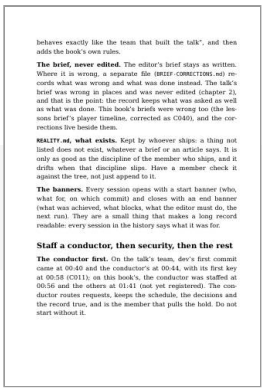
☐ AGREED ☐ NOT AGREED (NOTE BELOW)

DECISION

One meaning of 'joined' for the whole book

historian-03

12-build-your-own.md, RC1 page 248 · claims C011



behaves exactly like the team that built the talk", and then adds the book's own rules.

The brief, never edited. The editor's brief stays as written. Where it is wrong, a separate file (`BRIEF-CORRECTIONS.md`) records what was wrong and what was done instead. The talk's brief was wrong in places and was never edited (chapter 2), and that is the point: the record keeps what was asked as well as what was done. This book's briefs were wrong too (the lessons brief's player timeline, corrected as C040), and the corrections live beside them.

REALITY.md, what exists. Kept by whoever ships: a thing not listed does not exist, whatever a brief or an article says. It is only as good as the discipline of the member who ships, and it drifts when that discipline slips. Have a member check it against the tree, not just append to it.

The banners. Every session opens with a start banner (who, what for, on which commit) and closes with an end banner (what was achieved, what blocks, what the editor must do, the next run). They are a small thing that makes a long record readable: every session in the history says what it was for.

Staff a conductor, then security, then the rest

The conductor first. On the talk's team, dev's first commit came at 00:40 and the conductor's at 00:44, with its first key at 00:58 (C011); on this book's, the conductor was staffed at 00:56 and the others at 01:41 (not yet registered). The conductor routes requests, keeps the schedule, the decisions and the record true, and is the member that pulls the hold. Do not start without it.

> On the talk's team, dev's first commit came at 00:40 and the conductor's at 00:44, with its first key at 00:58 (C011); on this book's, the conductor was staffed at 00:56 and the others at 01:41 (not yet registered).

Chapters 1, 2 and 7 date the conductor from 00:44 and deck from 00:51, their join commits (97b98d9, 20ab1a3). Chapter 12 says the conductor joined at 00:58, and the register lists deck at 02:20 (C011). Appendix A shows why: C011 mixes methods, first commits for dev and ruv-sgit, first published keys for the rest. A reader will meet three times for the same event.

- [ ] A: Joined means the member's join commit (dev 00:40, conductor 00:44, deck 00:51, ruv-sgit 01:08); key times appear only in chapter 3
- [ ] B: Joined means the first published key, as C011's command prints, for every member
- [ ] C: Give both wherever they differ
- [ ] Something else (below)

Done in this RC1: Partly: ch12 and ch3 now give the conductor's first commit (00:44) and first key (00:58) as C011 does; the one-meaning decision is still the editor's.

Recommended: A: the join commit is the act the timeline and turning points use. Chapter 3's argument that membership is a published key keeps the key times, stated as such. The researcher restates C011 on one method.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

COMMENT

The 13:50 time is in the record after all

historian-04


The priority, and the order the editor set

The editor's briefs of about 14:00, committed by the conductor at 14:07 (c9ce46e), opened with a list headed "Priority, for everyone". Its first item was the player: port rwv.sgit.ai's talk player, make it work on an iPad, "This is the main priority, because the talk is at 19:00 London." The brief he dictated at about 13:50, in the same folder, says it in so many words: the player goes ahead of the append lane, "which becomes second" (team/conductor/briefs/2026-10-29_editor/feedback-briefs.md).

The lessons brief written for this book reads that sentence as the start of a failure: the player was the top priority and still not started at 14:53, and the lesson to carry is to start the highest-risk port first. The register corrects the reading, not the facts (C040). In the same hand-over, the conductor's notes record what the editor said after reading the conductor's review of his briefs. He wanted his feedback lane first: a pane on every page where he could leave notes, with voice, so that "a lot of the content now I'm going to be consuming in the browser" could be answered where he saw it. The conductor wrote the order down as it now stood: first, dev builds the editor's feedback pane and lane, and "the editor wakes dev for it now"; second, dev builds the player. The notes also record why the player could not simply be left to dev's schedule: a scheduled wake's work step was short, set for a team running alone at night, and dev's remaining slots before the evening could not carry a port of that size. The editor would wake dev himself.

The record then shows the order being followed exactly. Dev's scheduled wake at 14:06 fixed a label on the home page (3f17ce7, 14:08). The editor opened a wake in dev's session at 14:17 and the lane was built by 14:28 (9a51c28). The editor opened the next wake in dev's session at 14:58, and the player

07-building-the-talk.md, RC1 page 136 · claims C040

> The register corrects the reading, not the facts (C040).

C040 says no 13:50 time is attached to the player priority. One is: team/conductor/briefs/2026-10-29__editor/feedback-briefs.md opens 'From the editor ... about 13:50 London, dictated in a ... chat', and its first item calls the player 'the main priority', ahead of the append lane, 'which becomes second'. The folder's README is headed about 14:00. So the lessons brief's 13:50 holds; what changed is the order, in the conductor's notes of 14:05 (conductor-notes.md). Chapters 7 and 12 cite the README and miss the brief you dictated.

Done in this RC1: Ch7 now cites the brief dictated at about 13:50 (feedback-briefs.md), player first and lane 'second'; ch12 names the 13:50 brief. C040's note is for the researcher to re-correct.

Recommended: The researcher re-corrects C040; chapters 7 and 12 cite feedback-briefs.md as your words and conductor-notes.md as the reordering.

☐ AGREED ☐ NOT AGREED (NOTE BELOW)

QUESTION

Did you mean the lane before the player?

historian-05


landed at 15:07 (3314ffe, C028), going from 236 lines to 635 (C017). The build mode the editor had asked for at 14:10, which lets him set his own running order by dragging and present it at once, followed at 15:16 (f20c7a8).

So which reading does the record support? On the order of work, it supports the editor's. The team did not ignore a priority: a person reordered his own priorities under pressure, said so in his own words, and an agent team did exactly as told. The lane came first because the lane was how his notes on everything else, the player included, would reach the team. That is a defensible order, and the lessons brief's version, which leaves the reordering out, is unfair to it.

But the lessons brief's instinct survives in another form. The risk in the player was never the port. The port took one wake. The risk was what the editor would find when he started to use it, and he found it in the last hour. From 15:07 to 18:37 the player took twelve commits (C028), and those between 18:04 and 18:37 each carried the editor's own time in its subject: 18:05, 18:10, 18:15, 18:25 (23179cc, 12e95bb, 013497e, db475ad, with the what-changed view at 18:06, 13e1321). The fixes were small and specific: going back across a slide boundary landed in the wrong place, a step stopped the play, the bar did not fit an iPad on its side, two back steps in a row while playing found the same step twice. They are the notes of a person rehearsing. At the end of the day the player was 977 lines (C017), more than four times the size it had been at lunchtime, and its last change, at 18:37, came twenty-three minutes before the talk was due to start (C018).

07-building-the-talk.md, RC1 page 137

> On the order of work, it supports the editor's.

Chapters 7 and 12 say you reordered your own priorities, lane first and player second, and call the lessons brief unfair for leaving that out. Your dictated brief of about 13:50 put the player first and the lane second in so many words. The reversal rests on the conductor's notes of 14:05, which quote you calling the lane 'quite a priority' and offering to wake dev for it; the words 'first' and 'second' are the conductor's. Did you mean the lane to go ahead of the player, or alongside it? Chapter 7's lesson, and the fairness of chapter 12's table, turn on your answer.

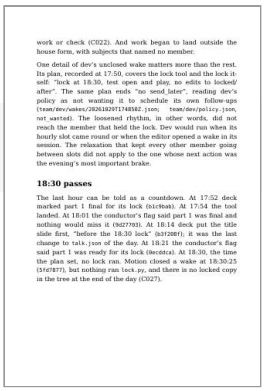
YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

COMMENT

There was a commit at 18:30

historian-06

08-the-locks-that-never-closed.md, RC1 page 156 · claims C027



> Motion closed a wake at 18:30:25 (`5fd7877`), but nothing ran `lock.py`, and there is no locked copy in the tree at the end of the day (C027).

Motion committed at 18:30:25 (5fd7877, closing its 18:25 wake) and merged at 18:30:27 (3e14cd4). What did not happen at 18:30 is the lock: no run of lock.py, no locked/ folder, no part in the lock list (C027). The point stands, but the sentence is checkable and false, in the chapter about checking.

Done in this RC1: Ch8: 'no commit at 18:30' replaced with 'no lock ran', naming motion's 18:30:25 commit.

Recommended: Rewrite as: 'At 18:30, the time the plan set, no lock ran.'

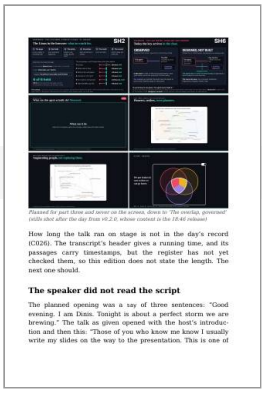
☐ AGREED ☐ NOT AGREED (NOTE BELOW)

DECISION

State how long the talk ran, from the transcript?

historian-07

10-the-talk-as-given.md, RC1 page 193 · claims C026



> How long the talk ran on stage is not in the day's record (C026).

Chapter 10 declines to give the talk's length because the register has no entry. The transcript article added after the day (a9c0b49) states a running time in its header, timestamps every passage and counts the passages from the room. They are the strongest evidence for the chapter's claim that the questions consumed the close, and without them the claim is an impression. The planned length is registered (C026); the actual one is not.

- ☐ A: The researcher registers the running time and the room's share from a9c0b49, marked added after the day, and chapter 10 states them
- ☐ B: Leave them unstated until the passage timestamps are checked against the recording
- ☐ C: You give the recording's own length, and that is registered
- ☐ Something else (below)

Recommended: A, after the researcher checks the header against the passage timestamps; C only if the two disagree.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

DECISION

Your own transcripts behind the key quotations

historian-08

06-the-editor-signs.md, RC1 page 122



> The record of what he decided lives in many files, each quoted by the agent that heard it, and a decision is only as authentic as that agent's quotation.

Several turning points rest on an agent's quotation of you: the 18:44 'pause all actions', the 17:40 'So I agree with all those policies', the lane-versus-player order, the lock moved to 19:00. Chapter 6 says plainly that each is only as good as the quoting agent. Decision Q4 says your voice memos and chat transcripts enter the source when you share them; O4 keeps RC1 to the record.

- [ ] A: Share the chat transcripts of 29 October for those moments, cited as added after the day, before the revision
- [ ] B: Keep the record only, and add one line in chapter 0 that your words are as your agents recorded them
- [ ] C: B in this revision, A for the first edition
- [ ] Something else (below)

Recommended: C: the caveat costs a sentence now; the transcripts can then confirm or correct the four moments the argument leans on.

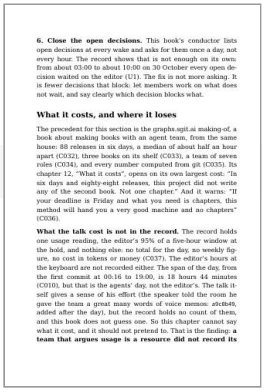
YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

QUESTION

Can you supply the day's usage and your hours?

historian-09

12-build-your-own.md, RC1 page 256 · claims C021, C037



> So this chapter cannot say what it cost, and it should not pretend to.

The register holds one usage reading for the day, your 95% of a five-hour window at 18:44, and nothing else: no daily total, no weekly figure, no money, no hours at the keyboard (C021, C037). Only you can supply them. Could you add your usage page for 29 October, or a note of it, to the talk's repository, to be cited as added after the day? Without it chapter 12's cost section stays 'not recorded', which is honest but is also the section a sceptical reader turns to first.

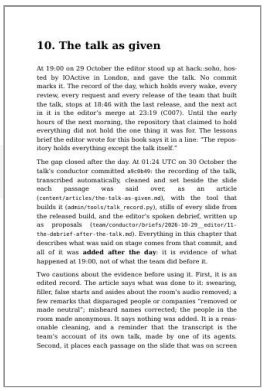
YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

COMMENT

The stills come from a build made after the talk

historian-10

10-the-talk-as-given.md, RC1 page 186 · claims C005, C007



10. The talk as given

At 19:00 on 29 October the editor stood up at hack::soho, hosted by IOActive in London, and gave the talk. No commit marks it. The record of the day, which holds every wake, every review, every request and every release of the team that built the talk, stops at 18:46 with the last release, and the next act in it is the editor's merge at 23:19 (C007). Until the early hours of the next morning, the repository that claimed to hold everything did not hold the one thing it was for. The lessons brief the editor wrote for this book says it in a line. "The repository holds everything except the talk itself."

The gap closed after the day. At 01:24 UTC on 30 October the talk's conductor committed a1cd4e9: the recording of the talk, transcribed automatically, cleaned and set beside the slide each passage was said over, as an article (`content/articles/the-talk-as-given.md`), with the tool that builds it (`admin/tools/talk_record.py`), stills of every slide from the released build, and the editor's spoken debrief, written up as proposals (`team/conductor/briefs/2026-10-29_editor/11-the-debrief-after-the-talk.md`). Everything in this chapter that describes what was said on stage comes from that commit, and all of it was **added after the day**: it is evidence of what happened at 19:00, not of what the team did before it.

Two cautions about the evidence before using it. First, it is an edited record. The article says what was done to it: swearing, filler, false starts and asides about the room's audio removed; a few remarks that disparaged people or companies "removed or made neutral"; misheard names corrected; the people in the room made anonymous. It says nothing was added. It is a reasonable cleaning, and a reminder that the transcript is the team's account of its own talk, made by one of its agents. Second, it places each passage on the slide that was on screen

> The gap closed after the day.

The transcript article and its tool say the slides are 'the talk as released in v0.2.0', shot from that build. v0.2.0 is the merge at 23:19 (C007), after the talk; on stage the site was the 18:46 release, v0.1.209 (C005). The stills are still faithful: decision S7 records that 298be4e and cb5b996 differ only in ./version. But a reader who checks will find the book illustrating the talk with a post-talk build.

Done in this RC1: Ch0 'What came later' and every slide-still caption (chs 0, 1, 3, 5 to 11) now say the stills were shot after the day from v0.2.0, whose content is the 18:46 release (C005, C007).

Recommended: Say once, in chapter 0's 'How to read the record', that the stills were shot after the day from v0.2.0, whose content is the 18:46 release.

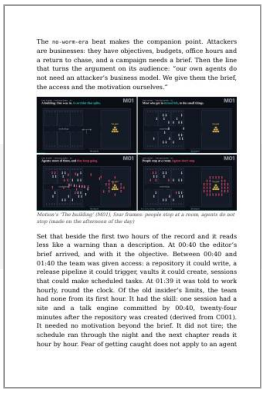
☐ AGREED ☐ NOT AGREED (NOTE BELOW)

COMMENT

The record does not show dev's session start

historian-11

02-midnight-an-empty-repository.md, RC1 page 52 · claims C001



The no-work-era beat makes the companion point. Attackers are businesses: they have objectives, budgets, office hours and a return to chase, and a campaign needs a brief. Then the line that turns the argument on its audience: "our own agents do not need an attacker's business model. We give them the brief, the access and the motivation ourselves."

Motion's 'The building' (0401): four frames, people step at a room, agents do not stop (inside on the afternoon of the day)

Set that beside the first two hours of the record and it reads less like a warning than a description. At 00:40 the editor's brief arrived, and with it the objective. Between 00:40 and 01:40 the team was given access: a repository it could write, a release pipeline it could trigger, vaults it could create, sessions that could make scheduled tasks. At 01:39 it was told to work hourly, round the clock. Of the old insider's limits, the team had none from its first hour. It had the skill: one session had a site and a talk engine committed by 00:40, twenty-four minutes after the repository was created (derived from C001). It needed no motivation beyond the brief. It did not tire; the schedule ran through the night and the next chapter reads it hour by hour. Fear of getting caught does not apply to an agent

> It had the skill: one session had a site and a talk engine committed by 00:40, twenty-four minutes after the repository was created (derived from C001).

'Twenty-four minutes' measures from your empty repository at 00:16:23 (C001) to dev's first commit at 00:40:50. The record does not hold when dev's session started: it may have been working from the brief before the repository existed, or for only a few minutes. The chapter's argument does not need the duration, and the same claim appears in chapter 2's opening ('Nothing else happened in it for twenty-four minutes', which is accurate).

Done in this RC1: Ch2: rewritten as proposed, a commit gap, not a build time.

Recommended: Rewrite as: 'one session had a site and a talk engine committed by 00:40, twenty-four minutes after the repository was created.'

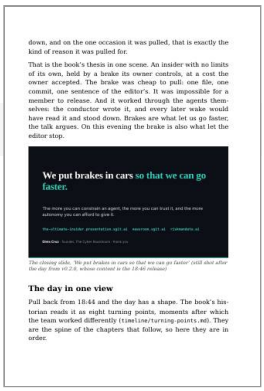
☐ AGREED ☐ NOT AGREED (NOTE BELOW)

DECISION

Turning points in the day's order

historian-12

01-pause-all-actions.md, RC1 page 37


down, and on the one occasion it was pulled, that is exactly the kind of reason it was pulled for.

That is the book's thesis in one scene. An insider with no limits of its own, held by a brake its owner controls, at a cost the owner accepted. The brake was cheap to pull: one file, one commit, one sentence of the editor's. It was impossible for a member to release. And it worked through the agents themselves: the conductor wrote it, and every later wake would have read it and stood down. Brakes are what let us go faster, the talk argues. On this evening the brake is also what let the editor stop.

We put brakes in cars so that we can go faster.

The more you can constrain an agent, the more you can trust it, and the more autonomy you can afford to give it.

the-officials-insider-presentation.opt.ai exercise.opt.ai rtimelents.ai

Drew Cline · Reader, Pre-Flight Boulevard · thank you

The closing slide. 'We put brakes in cars so that we can go faster' (still shot after the day from v0.2.8, whose content is the 18:46 release)

The day in one view

Pull back from 18:44 and the day has a shape. The book's historian reads it as eight turning points, moments after which the team worked differently (`timeline/turning-points.md`). They are the spine of the chapters that follow, so here they are in order.

> Pull back from 18:44 and the day has a shape.

Chapter 1's 'day in one view' lists the freeze (02:47) before the five-step wake (02:14 to 02:51), and point 6, '15:00 to 15:47', includes the storyteller at 14:15. The list follows the numbering in timeline/turning-points.md, where the freeze was found later and inserted as point 3. Chapter 0 tells the reader to use this list as the map of the book, so it will be read as a sequence.

- [ ] A: Renumber in time order everywhere (the five-step wake third, the freeze fourth) and widen point 6 to start at 14:12
- [ ] B: Keep the numbering and say once that the points are numbered as they were found
- [ ] C: Reorder chapter 1's list only and keep the timeline's ids
- [ ] Something else (below)

Recommended: A: one order, the day's own; the historian renumbers the timeline and the chapters' TP references follow.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

The librarian

a conductor sub-agent reading as the librarian (not the member's own words)

> *RC1 is well sourced: every file ends with where it came from, and no commit or register id in those lists fails to resolve. The gaps are at the edges: numbers and citations taken from the Cold-Read team without a pin or a register id, images and room quotations with no stated licence or consent, and a few statements left stale or contradicted between chapters.*

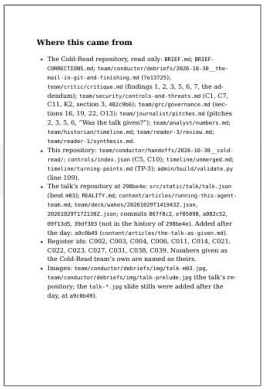
DECISION

Cold-Read numbers have no register ids

librarian-01

11-what-the-cold-reader-saw.md, RC1 page 216

> Numbers given as the Cold-Read team's own are named as theirs.



Where this came from

- The Cold-Read repository, read only: BRIEF.md; BRIEF-CORRECTIONS.md; team/conductor/debriefs/2026-10-30__the-mail-in-git-and-finishing.md (7e13725); team/critic/critique.md (findings 1, 2, 3, 5, 6, 7, the addendum); team/security/controls-and-threats.md (C1, C7, C11, K2, section 3, 482c9b6); team/pir/governance.md (sections 16, 19, 22, O13); team/journalist/pitches.md (pitches 2, 3, 5, 6, "Was the talk given?"); team/analyst/numbers.md; team/historian/timeline.md; team/reader-1/review.md; team/reader-1/synthesis.md.
- This repository: team/conductor/handoffs/2026-10-30__cold-read/: controls/index.json (C5, C10); timeline/unmerged.md; timeline/turning-points.md (TP-3); admin/build/validate.py (line 109).
- The talk's repository at 298be6e: src/static/talk/talk.json (beat.m63); REALITY.md; content/articles/running-this-agent-team.md; team/deck/wakes/20261029T141943Z.json, 20261029T171139Z.json; commits 8b778c2, ef85098, a082c52, 09f13d5, 39df303 (not in the history of 298be6e). Added after the day: a9c0b49 (content/articles/the-talk-as-given.md).
- Register ids: C002, C003, C004, C006, C011, C014, C021, C022, C023, C027, C031, C038, C039. Numbers given as the Cold-Read team's own are named as theirs.
- Images: team/conductor/debriefs/img/talk-m03.jpg, team/conductor/debriefs/img/talk-prelude.jpg (the talk's repository; the talk-*.jpg slide stills were added after the day, at a9c0b49).

Chapter 11 states counts from the Cold-Read team with no register id: its member count, the critic's two commit counts from the talk's slides, the analyst's conductor and merge counts, the security member's records with an earlier change, the governance member's out-of-order wakes. Chapter 9 adds the seconds between the hold and the designer's commit. The book's rules make the register the only place a number may come from, and Appendix A promises every number can be rerun.

- [ ] A: The researcher registers each, sourced to the Cold-Read repository at a pinned commit and rerun from the talk's history
- [ ] B: Remove the numbers and describe the disagreements in words
- [ ] C: Allow attributed numbers, by an exception stated in chapter 0
- [ ] Something else (below)

Recommended: A: the disagreements of definition are chapter 11's best material, and the appendix promise should cover every number in print.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

DECISION

Pin and label every Cold-Read citation

librarian-02

11-what-the-cold-reader-saw.md, RC1 page 205



11. What the cold reader saw

Every chapter so far was written from inside. This book's team read the talk's repository knowing what the talk was for, who the editor was, when the day ended and what came after it; it had the editor's briefs, his corrections and, later, the talk as given. That is an advantage, and it is also a blind spot. An insider reads the record through what it already knows, and stops looking where it thinks it has the answer.

So on the night of 30 October a second team was set to read the same record without any of that. The Cold-Read team (cold-read.lbe-ultimate-insider, in its own repository) was given one thing: the talk's repository, pinned at 298ea4e, "Nothing else: no briefing on what it is, no memo, no transcript, no contact with any other team" (its BRIEF.md). It worked under a rule of ignorance: everything it said had to come from that repository, with the path and commit that shows it, and where the record was silent it wrote "the record does not say". "Guessing is a finding against you." Its conductor counted twelve members running by about 02:00 UTC: a historian, a technologist, security, a governance member, a journalist, an analyst, a critic and five synthetic readers, each in its own session with its own key, working the same five-step wake the talk's team had built, ported from the source itself.

CONCEPT: THE COLD READ

A second team given only the talk's repository at 298ea4e: no brief, no memo, no transcript, no contact. Everything it says cites a path and commit; where the record is silent it says so. It sees what the insiders stopped looking for.

This chapter reads its finished work against this book's. Where the two agree, the record is solid. Where the cold reader found what this team missed, the insider's view was blind. Where

> This chapter reads its finished work against this book's.

Chapters 9 and 11 cite Cold-Read files by path with no commit, except 7e13725 and 482c9b6. The librarian indexed that repository at 0dc6854, which is not in the conductor's read-only clone (latest 9e6a7a1, 09:54); the Cold-Read team kept working after both. And its paths read as this repository's own: team/security/controls-and-threats.md or team/historian/timeline.md could be ours. A reader cannot tell which team said what, or at which state.

- [ ] A: One stated pin for the Cold-Read repository in chapter 11's sources, and every path prefixed by its repository (Cold-Read, talk, book) in every chapter
- [ ] B: A commit beside every Cold-Read citation
- [ ] C: Leave as drafted
- [ ] Something else (below)

Recommended: A: one pin the librarian confirms against the repository itself, and one prefix convention for all three repositories; it also settles the ambiguity check_sources.py reports.

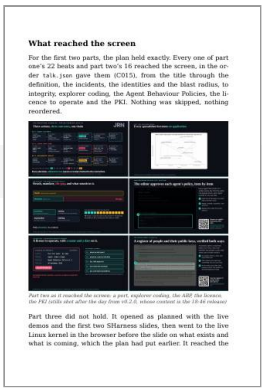
YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

DECISION

Under what licence do the images print?

librarian-03

10-the-talk-as-given.md, RC1 page 189


What reached the screen

For the first two parts, the plan held exactly. Every one of part one's 22 beats and part two's 16 reached the screen, in the order `talk.json` gave them (C015), from the title through the definition, the incidents, the identities and the blast radius, to integrity, explorer coding, the Agent Behaviour Policies, the licence to operate and the PKI. Nothing was skipped, nothing reordered.

Part two as it reached the screen: a port, explorer coding, the ABP, the licence, the PKI (title shot after the day-four v0.2.0_release content in the 10-84 release)

Part three did not hold. It opened as planned with the live demos and the first two SIFarness slides, then went to the live Linux kernel in the browser before the slide on what exists and what is coming, which the plan had put earlier. It reached the

> For the first two parts, the plan held exactly.

Every chapter prints images copied from the talk's repository, which is Apache-2.0; the book's text is CC BY 4.0 (decision Q5). Several stills carry third-party material: the definition slide credits a vendor-commissioned survey, slide footers cite outside authors' work, the title slide names the host. Nothing in RC1 says under what licence the pictures may be reused, and a CC BY reader will assume CC BY.

- [ ] A: You, as owner of the talk's repository, release the reproduced images under CC BY 4.0, with a credits page listing each image's source path, commit and licence
- [ ] B: Keep them Apache-2.0 and add a notice page saying the images are not CC BY
- [ ] C: Replace the stills that carry third-party credits with descriptions
- [ ] Something else (below)

Recommended: A, with the credits page built from each chapter's image list (every one already names its source path); the third-party credits stay visible as attribution, not as licensed content.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

DECISION

Quoting the room and the host

librarian-04

10-the-talk-as-given.md, RC1 page 198



build it on ...”), and over the PKI (“If you want a business to build, I think this would be a great one”). The call reached the room as a refrain rather than a close.

The team as the example. The team beat planned “the turn”: this site is made by agents with roles, mandates and reviews, and “without its policies, a team like this goes off-piste just as fast”. The speaker went further than the script, over the same slide: “If I turned what I did here on a target, can you imagine the damage it would do? ... I think the real danger is not criminal exploitation, it is benign agents going rogue.” That sentence is this book’s argument, said on stage before the book existed: the benign team is the insider, and its brakes are the evidence. The speaker said it as an idea; the chapters before this one make it from the record.

An incident changed jobs. One of the incident stories planned for the `\snits` beat, where it illustrated an agent that does not stop, was told instead over the last beat of part one, the mapped deployment (`s-e87`), where it illustrated the mandate: an agent doing exactly what its grant allowed and nothing its user meant. This book does not repeat the incident, which has no entry in its register.

The room

The transcript places questions and comments from the room after part one and through parts two and three. Their range says something about who the talk was for. *They asked* whose responsibility it is to limit an agent’s capability, whether the bottleneck is education, how the harness compares with existing policy engines and credential services, how it would inspect a database payload, and what it was written in.

Two of them go to the centre of this book. The first, that an agent is “just like another human” and the old disciplines ap-

> They asked whose responsibility it is to limit an agent's capability, whether the bottleneck is education, how the harness compares with existing policy engines and credential services, how it would inspect a database payload, and what it was written in.

Chapter 10 quotes and paraphrases questions from the room and the host's introduction, from a transcript the talk's conductor cleaned and anonymised (a9c0b49, added after the day). Under CC BY 4.0 anyone may reuse those words. Only you know how the recording was made, and whether the host and the room knew it might be published.

- ☐ A: Paraphrase the room, quote only the speaker verbatim, and add one sentence on how the recording was made
- ☐ B: Quote the room verbatim as now, anonymised
- ☐ C: Ask the host before print
- ☐ Something else (below)

Recommended: A: the argument needs what was asked, not the exact words, and a sentence on the recording answers a careful reader's first question.

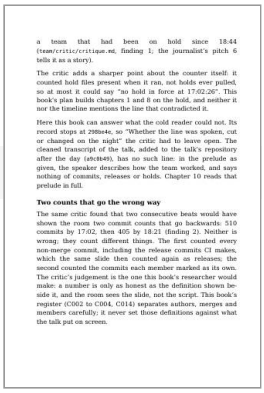
YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

COMMENT

Pictures carry numbers the register never saw

librarian-05

11-what-the-cold-reader-saw.md, RC1 page 208 · claims C031



a team that had been on hold since 18:44 (`team/critic/critique.md`, finding 1; the journalist’s pitch 6 tells it as a story).

The critic adds a sharper point about the counter itself: it counted hold flies present when it ran, not holds ever pulled, so at most it could say “no hold in force at 17:02:26”. This book’s plan builds chapters 1 and 8 on the hold, and neither it nor the timeline mentions the line that contradicted it.

Here this book can answer what the cold reader could not. Its record stops at `298e44c`, so “Whether the line was spoken, cut or changed on the night” the critic had to leave open. The cleaned transcript of the talk, added to the talk’s repository after the day (`a9c0b49`), has no such line: in the prelude as given, the speaker describes how the team worked, and says nothing of commits, releases or holds. Chapter 10 reads that prelude in full.

Two counts that go the wrong way

The same critic found that two consecutive beats would have shown the room two commit counts that go backwards: 510 commits by 17:02, then 405 by 18:21 (finding 2). Neither is wrong; they count different things. The first counted every non-merge commit, including the release commits CI makes, which the same slide then counted again as releases; the second counted the commits each member marked as its own. The critic’s judgement is the one this book’s researcher would make: a number is only as honest as the definition shown beside it, and the room sees the slide, not the script. This book’s register (C002 to C004, C014) separates authors, merges and members carefully; it never set those definitions against what the talk put on screen.

> Neither is wrong; they count different things.

The rule that every number is traced covers the text, not the images. The 'Meet the team' still, printed in chapters 10 and 11, shows the talk's own counter at 17:02: hours, commits, releases, wakes, overnight commits and holds. Chapter 11's argument rests on those figures, yet none has an entry. The definition still shows the survey figure, which does (C031).

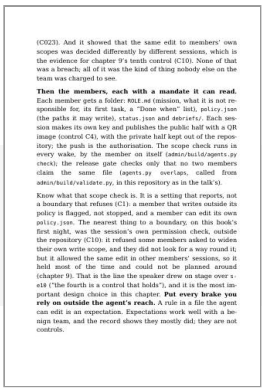
Recommended: Each caption that shows a number names its register id or says 'the talk's own figures, as shown on the night'; the researcher registers the 17:02 counter, since chapter 11 argues from it.

☐ AGREED ☐ NOT AGREED (NOTE BELOW)

COMMENT

Chapter 12 contradicts chapter 3 on the scope check

librarian-06



12-build-your-own.md, RC1 page 250

> The scope check runs in every wake, by the member on itself (`admin/build/agents.py check`); the release gate checks only that no two members claim the same file (`agents.py overlaps`, called from `admin/build/validate.py`, in this repository as in the talk's).

Chapter 3 is right: 'Nothing in the release pipeline runs it.' admin/build/validate.py calls agents.py only with 'overlaps' (check_team), in the talk's repository and in this one; the member runs 'check' on itself in its wake. Chapter 12 says the opposite, in the chapter a builder will copy, and a reader who trusts it will believe the setting refuses releases when it only reports.

Done in this RC1: Ch12 now agrees with ch3: self-run check in every wake, gate runs overlaps only.

Recommended: Rewrite as: 'The scope check runs in every wake, by the member on itself; the gate checks only that no two members claim the same file.'

☐ AGREED ☐ NOT AGREED (NOTE BELOW)

COMMENT

Two decisions printed as open are signed

librarian-07



12-build-your-own.md, RC1 page 255

> By morning, the conductor was asking him whether idle members should pause, since "each wake costs some of your usage" and some members had nothing to do until the plan was signed (U1, decided at about 10:40 UTC, moot by then).

book.json records U1 and C10b as decided by your word of about 10:40 UTC, with Q3, Q4, O4, L1 and L2. Chapter 12 still marks U1 open, and chapter 9 says book.json 'holds the open decision C10b'. Both chapters were drafted from the state before your 10:40 word.

Done in this RC1: Ch12: U1 marked decided (about 10:40 UTC); ch9: C10b now said settled by the editor at about 10:40 UTC.

Recommended: Update both, and have the publisher check every decision id a chapter names against book.json before each print.

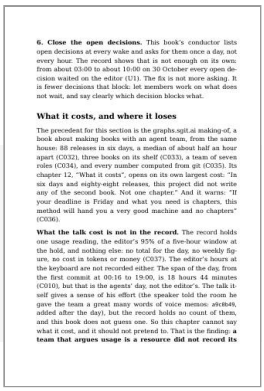
☐ AGREED ☐ NOT AGREED (NOTE BELOW)

COMMENT

Cite the making-of itself, not our note on it

librarian-08

12-build-your-own.md, RC1 page 256



> The precedent for this section is the graphs.sgit.ai making-of, a book about making books with an agent team, from the same house: 88 releases in six days, a median of about half an hour apart (C032), three books on its shelf (C033), a team of seven roles (C034), and every number computed from git (C035).

Chapter 12 quotes the graphs.sgit.ai making-of verbatim twice and cites it only through claims/graphs-sgit-ai.md, the researcher's note. Quoted text from another book needs its own attribution: its title, where it is published, and the commit read. Appendix A already names SGit-AI__Website__Graphs at d39e717; the chapter does not.

Recommended: Add a source line naming the making-of, its site and d39e717, with the claims note as the check behind the numbers.

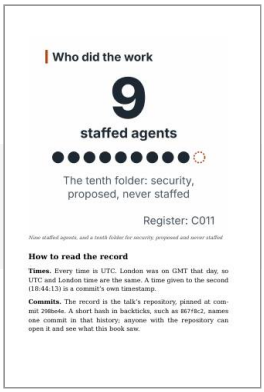
☐ AGREED ☐ NOT AGREED (NOTE BELOW)

RATIONALE

Why the source lists use shorthand in RC1

librarian-09

00-before-you-start.md, RC1 page 9



> A short hash in backticks, such as `867f8c2`, names one commit in that history; anyone with the repository can open it and see what this book saw.

Every RC1 file, from the about page to Appendix A, ends with 'Where this came from'. The librarian's index/tools/check_sources.py finds no missing commit or register id in any of them; Appendix A's d39e717 is in a fourth repository the tool does not read. What it flags is shorthand (day/14.md, story/tree.md, a bare policy.json) and the slide stills added after the day, which every source list already says. The shorthand was kept so each list stays readable on paper.

Recommended: Expand to full paths in the revision: a reader holding only the book cannot resolve 'day/14.md'.

☐ AGREED ☐ NOT AGREED (NOTE BELOW)

DECISION

The talk team's vaults: inside or outside the record?

librarian-10



04-the-hourly-machine.md, RC1 page 86

> Making the team's correspondence public is the most counter-intuitive choice in the machine, and on reflection one of the soundest.

The talk team's board and mail lived in two public vaults outside git, and the researcher's evidence in a third. RC1 reaches them only through git files that mirrored them (requests folders, routing commits, the 07:18 vault-history note), and the index covers git only. The evidence vault's history still holds other sites' tokens (D12 was never decided), so the book must never print its read key or link into it.

- [ ] A: Say in chapter 0 that vault contents are outside the record, cited only through git
- [ ] B: The librarian indexes the public vaults read-only, by their published read keys, cited by vault commit
- [ ] C: Leave it to the first edition
- [ ] Something else (below)

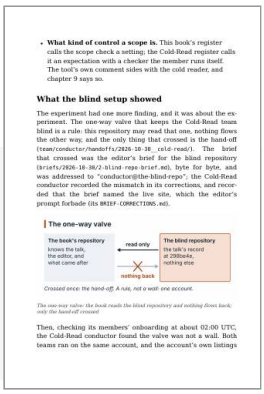
Recommended: A for this revision: your 'no vaults for now' and the unsettled D12 argue against reaching into them; B only at your word.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

COMMENT

The brief that crossed was the editor's, not ours

librarian-11



11-what-the-cold-reader-saw.md, RC1 page 214

> The brief that crossed was the editor's brief for the blind repository (`briefs/2026-10-30/2-blind-repo-brief.md`), byte for byte, and was addressed to "conductor@the-blind-repo"; the Cold-Read conductor recorded the mismatch in its corrections, and recorded that the brief named the live site, which the editor's prompt forbade (its `BRIEF-CORRECTIONS.md`).

'This book's own' reads as if this team's material crossed the valve. The file that crossed is the editor's brief for the blind repository, briefs/2026-10-30/2-blind-repo-brief.md, identical to team/conductor/handoffs/2026-10-30__cold-read/BRIEF.md (checked). Its address and the live-site link were in that brief from the start, and the hand-off README lists what was deliberately left out. The valve held; the mismatch was in the brief's wording.

Done in this RC1: Ch11: names the editor's blind-repo brief as what crossed (checked identical to the hand-off BRIEF.md).

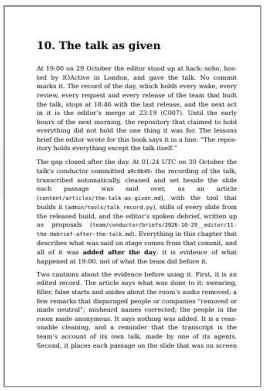
Recommended: Name the file and say the hand-off was the only thing that crossed, as its README records.

- [ ] AGREED
- [ ] NOT AGREED (NOTE BELOW)

QUESTION

Will you add the raw transcript of the talk?

librarian-12



10. The talk as given

At 19:00 on 29 October the editor stood up at hack:soho, hosted by IOActive in London, and gave the talk. No commit marks it. The record of the day, which holds every wake, every review, every request and every release of the team that built the talk, stops at 18:46 with the last release, and the next act in it is the editor's merge at 23:19 (C007). Until the early hours of the next morning, the repository that claimed to hold everything did not hold the one thing it was for. The lessons brief the editor wrote for this book says it in a line. "The repository holds everything except the talk itself."

The gap closed after the day. At 01:24 UTC on 30 October the talk's conductor committed a6cb649: the recording of the talk, transcribed automatically, cleaned and set beside the slide each passage was said over, as an article (content/articles/the-talk-as-given.md), with the tool that builds it (admin/tools/talk_record.py), stills of every slide from the released build, and the editor's spoken debrief, written up as proposals (team/conductor/briefs/2026-10-29_editor/11-the-debrief-after-the-talk.md). Everything in this chapter that describes what was said on stage comes from that commit, and all of it was **added after the day**: it is evidence of what happened at 19:00, not of what the team did before it.

Two cautions about the evidence before using it. First, it is an edited record. The article says what was done to it: swearing, filler, false starts and asides about the room's audio removed; a few remarks that disparaged people or companies "removed or made neutral"; misheard names corrected; the people in the room made anonymous. It says nothing was added. It is a reasonable cleaning, and a reminder that the transcript is the team's account of its own talk, made by one of its agents. Second, it places each passage on the slide that was on screen

10-the-talk-as-given.md, RC1 page 186

> First, it is an edited record.

Every quotation in chapter 10 comes from team/conductor/talk-record/transcript.json, the record the talk's conductor cleaned with sub-agents: swearing, filler and some remarks removed or made neutral, names corrected, the room anonymised. The cleaning is described honestly but cannot be checked, because neither the recording nor the automatic transcript is in the source. Decision Q4 says they enter it when you share them. Will you add the automatic transcript (it need not be printed) so each quotation can be traced to what was said?

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

The researcher

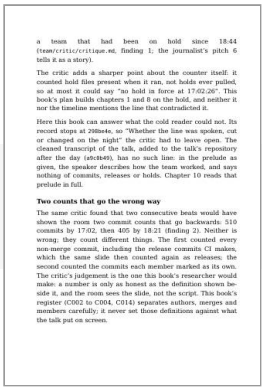
a conductor sub-agent reading as the researcher (not the member's own words)

> *RC1 keeps to the register far better than the briefs did: nearly every number carries its id and the failures are told with checked figures. The gaps are the Cold-Read team's counts, printed without entries; a few mis-cited ids; two entries to correct before print (C011's mixed join times, C014's note and merge method); a missing entry for the evidence vault's history; and a handful of small unregistered or derived figures.*

DECISION

The Cold-Read team's numbers need register entries

researcher-01



a team that had been on hold since 18:44 (team/critic/critique.md, finding 1; the journalist's pitch 6 tells it as a story).

The critic adds a sharper point about the counter itself: it counted hold files present when it ran, not holds ever pulled, so at most it could say "no hold in force at 17:02:26". This book's plan builds chapters 1 and 8 on the hold, and neither it nor the timeline mentions the line that contradicted it.

Here this book can answer what the cold reader could not. Its record stops at 298be4e, so "Whether the line was spoken, cut or changed on the night" the critic had to leave open. The cleaned transcript of the talk, added to the talk's repository after the day (a9cb4e0), has no such line: in the prelude as given, the speaker describes how the team worked, and says nothing of commits, releases or holds. Chapter 10 reads that prelude in full.

Two counts that go the wrong way

The same critic found that two consecutive beats would have shown the room two commit counts that go backwards: 510 commits by 17:02, then 405 by 18:21 (finding 2). Neither is wrong; they count different things. The first counted every non-merge commit, including the release commits CI makes, which the same slide then counted again as releases; the second counted the commits each member marked as its own. The critic's judgement is the one this book's researcher would make: a number is only as honest as the definition shown beside it, and the room sees the slide, not the script. This book's register (C002 to C004, C014) separates authors, merges and members carefully; it never set those definitions against what the talk put on screen.

11-what-the-cold-reader-saw.md, RC1 page 208

> The same critic found that two consecutive beats would have shown the room two commit counts that go backwards: 510 commits by 17:02, then 405 by 18:21 (finding 2).

Chapters 9 and 11 print counts that are the Cold-Read team's own, not this register's: the two commit counts in this sentence, its members running by 02:00, the seconds between the hold and the designer's commit, the policies with no record but the conductor's, the wakes worked before review, its pre-review and merge counts, and the conductor's commits by prefix. The brief's rule is that every number comes from the register. Most can be rerun from the talk's repository at 298be4e and entered with the Cold-Read file as first source.

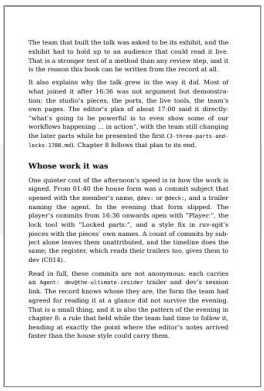
- [ ] A: register those the book argues from (the two commit counts, the merges, the hold gap) and describe or cut the rest
- [ ] B: keep them all, marked as the Cold-Read team's own, without ids
- [ ] C: register every one
- [ ] Something else (below)

Recommended: A: the rule holds where the argument rests, and a stranger's count stays visibly a stranger's where it is only colour.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

COMMENT **C014's note is wrong about the Agent trailers** researcher-02

07-building-the-talk.md, RC1 page 147 · claims C014



The team that built the talk was asked to be its exhibit, and the exhibit had to hold up to an audience that could read it live. That is a stronger test of a method than any review step, and it is the reason this book can be written from the record at all.

It also explains why the talk grew in the way it did. Most of what joined it after 16:36 was not argument but demonstration: the studio's pieces, the ports, the live tools, the team's own pages. The editor's plan of about 17:00 said it directly: "what's going to be powerful is to even show some of our workflows happening ... in action", with the team still changing the later parts while he presented the first (`3-three-parts-are-locks-1700.md`). Chapter 8 follows that plan to its end.

Whose work it was

One quieter cost of the afternoon's speed is in how the work is signed. From 01:40 the house form was a commit subject that opened with the member's name, `@dev:` or `@deck:`, and a trailer naming the agent. In the evening that form slipped. The player's commits from 16:36 onwards open with "Player:", the lock tool with "Locked parts:", and a style fix in ruv-sgit's pieces with the pieces' own names. A count of commits by subject alone leaves them unattributed, and the timeline does the same; the register, which reads their trailers too, gives them to dev (C014).

Read in full, these commits are not anonymous: each carries an `Agent: dev@the-ultimate-insider` trailer and dev's session link. The record knows whose they are, the form the team had agreed for reading it at a glance did not survive the evening. That is a small thing, and it is also the pattern of the evening in chapter 8: a rule that held while the team had time to follow it, bending at exactly the point where the editor's notes arrived faster than the house style could carry them.

> Read in full, these commits are not anonymous: each carries an `Agent: dev@the-ultimate-insider` trailer and dev's session link.

This sentence is right, and the register is not. A rerun at 298be4e finds an Agent trailer naming dev on dbd75ad, 013d97e, 12e93db, 23739cc, 4a2481b, 8289d50, bd32d97 and c33e86a, yet C014's note says the unattributed commits carry none. The counts stand, since C014 reads subjects; the note needs correcting. Chapter 3 should follow: it says the scope check was silent by construction for such commits, but agents.py reads the Agent line as well as the subject, so it could attribute these. The claim about ruv-sgit's commits without the @ holds: they carry no Agent line.

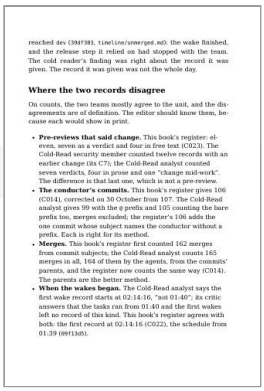
Done in this RC1: Ch7: the trailer-attributed commits are now given to dev by the register (C014: dev 64); ch3 now says the scope check reads the Agent line too, so its blind spot is ruv-sgit's 30 commits with neither mark.

☐ AGREED ☐ NOT AGREED (NOTE BELOW)

DECISION

Count merges by their parents, not their subjects

researcher-03


reached dev (39df381, timeline/unmerged.md): the wake finished, and the release step it relied on had stopped with the team. The cold reader's finding was right about the record it was given. The record it was given was not the whole day.

Where the two records disagree

On counts, the two teams mostly agree to the unit, and the disagreements are of definition. The editor should know them, because each would show in print.

- **Pre-reviews that said change.** This book's register: eleven, seven as a verdict and four in free text (C023). The Cold-Read security member counted twelve records with an earlier change (its C7); the Cold-Read analyst counted seven verdicts, four in prose and one "change mid-work". The difference is that last one, which is not a pre-review.
- **The conductor's commits.** This book's register gives 106 (C014), corrected on 30 October from 107. The Cold-Read analyst gives 99 with the g prefix and 105 counting the bare prefix too, merges excluded; the register's 106 adds the one commit whose subject names the conductor without a prefix. Each is right for its method.
- **Merges.** This book's register first counted 162 merges from commit subjects; the Cold-Read analyst counts 165 merges in all, 164 of them by the agents, from the commits' parents, and the register now counts the same way (C014). The parents are the better method.
- **When the wakes began.** The Cold-Read analyst says the first wake record starts at 02:14:16, "not 01:40"; its critic answers that the tasks run from 01:40 and the first wakes left no record of this kind. This book's register agrees with both: the first record at 02:14:16 (C022), the schedule from 01:39 (08f13d5).

11-what-the-cold-reader-saw.md, RC1 page 213 · claims C014, C003, C004

> The parents are the better method.

C014 gives 162 merges, counted by subject (C014). A rerun by parents at 298be4e agrees with the Cold-Read analyst's higher count in the sentence before this one, including your merge to main; some of the agents' merges have subjects that name a member and so sit inside the member counts. Chapter 11 already calls the parents the better method, so C014 and Appendix A should say which the book uses. The conductor's count also differs from a count of the @ form alone; the method printed beside it settles that.

- [ ] A: C014 counts merges by parents and members over non-merge commits; Appendix A prints the command
- [ ] B: keep counts by subject and state the method beside each number
- [ ] C: print only the totals by author (C003, C004)
- [ ] Something else (below)

Done in this RC1: Ch11 and Appendix A: merges now by parents, 165, 164 of them the agents' (C014 as corrected); conductor 106, dev 64, none unattributed.

Recommended: A: it is the reproducible definition, and it removes the one place where two careful counts of the same record disagree.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

DECISION

C011's join times mix two methods

researcher-04

03-a-mandate-you-can-read.md, RC1 page 74 · claims C011



> The register gives each member two dates, its first commit and its first published key (C011).

This sentence says the register dates every member by its first key commit. For seven members it does. For dev it gives the first commit of the day, and for ruv-sgit its join commit, both earlier than their first key, as Appendix A's own rerun shows (C011). The register's command prints keys, so a reader rerunning it gets other times for those two, and the chapter's explanation, which treats deck as the exception, is wrong in the other direction.

- [ ] A: date every member by its join commit; change C011's method and command, and this sentence
- [ ] B: date every member by its first key commit, as the command does, and move dev and ruv-sgit later
- [ ] C: print both columns in Appendix A
- [ ] Something else (below)

Done in this RC1: Ch3 now gives both C011 dates (first key and first commit); chs 2, 12 and Appendix A reworded to match the corrected entry.

Recommended: A: to a reader 'joined' means the first commit as a member; the key is the test of being staffed, not of when.

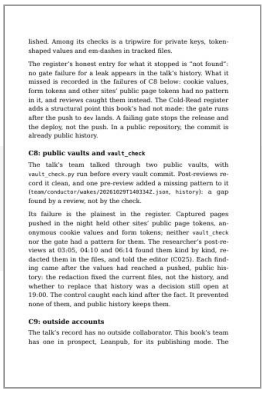
YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

COMMENT

A claim is needed for the evidence vault's history

researcher-05

09-the-team-was-the-insider.md, RC1 page 177 · claims C025



> Each finding came after the values had reached a pushed, public history: the redaction fixed the current files, not the history, and whether to replace that history was a decision still open at 19:00.

C025 records the repository side of the three token findings. What reached the evidence vault, a separate public store, is in the researcher's answer at 07:18 (aa7a3eb) and its counts file, and has no entry. Chapters 4, 6 and 9 need one: it shows cookie values went out at 02:22 and form tokens again at 05:23, which contradicts 'caught before its commit' here (security raises the wording). Claim needed: per vault commit, the time pushed and the counts by kind, from evidence/updates/2026-10-29__the-vault-history-checked.md at 298be4e, with its command.

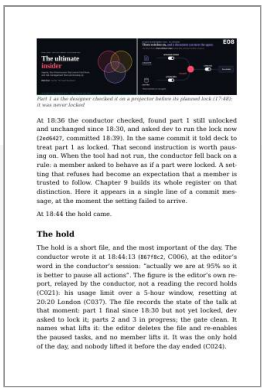
Done in this RC1: Ch9 wording corrected ('caught before its commit' removed); the new register entry for the vault history is still the researcher's to add.

- [ ] AGREED
- [ ] NOT AGREED (NOTE BELOW)

COMMENT

Three numbers carry the wrong claim id

researcher-06



08-the-locks-that-never-closed.md, RC1 page 158 · claims C024, C037, C006, C005, C023

> The figure is the editor's own report, relayed by the conductor, not a reading the record holds (C021): his usage limit over a 5-hour window, resetting at 20:20 London (C037).

Here the 5-hour window and the 20:20 reset are cited to C024, which holds the hold itself; they are in C037. In chapter 1, the three commits after the hold, one of them work, are cited to C006, which holds only the hold; the three commits are in C005. And in chapter 8 the pre-review times (17:21, 17:30, 17:45, 18:19) are cited to C023, which holds counts, not times: cite the conductor's wake records instead. Each is a one-word fix, and a reader of Appendix A will look the id up.

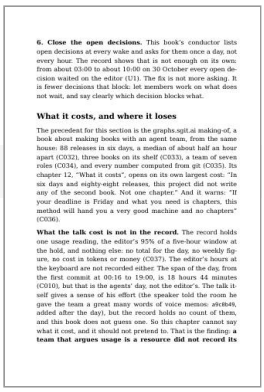
Done in this RC1: Ch8: 5-hour window and 20:20 now cite C037; ch1 three commits after the hold now cite C005 and C006 (C006's note holds the count); ch8 pre-review times keep C023 (its note lists them) and add the conductor's wake records.

☐ AGREED ☐ NOT AGREED (NOTE BELOW)

DECISION

Chapter 12's cost: your figure, or its absence

researcher-07



12-build-your-own.md, RC1 page 256 · claims C037, C021

> So this chapter cannot say what it cost, and it should not pretend to.

The record holds one usage reading for the day, 95% of a 5-hour window at the hold, and no total and no money (C037, still open). Chapter 12 makes the absence its finding. Only you hold the usage page and the bill; a figure added now is material from after the day and would be cited so. Separately, your reading for this book's team on 30 October is in book.json as decision Q2, not in the register; if chapter 12 uses it, it needs an entry.

- ☐ A: you supply the day's usage or cost, and the researcher registers it as added after the day
- ☐ B: keep 'not in the record' as the finding for this edition
- ☐ C: both: keep the finding, and add your figure beside it as a later note
- ☐ Something else (below)

Recommended: C: the finding is the lesson and should stay; a figure beside it, marked as later, answers the reader's first question.

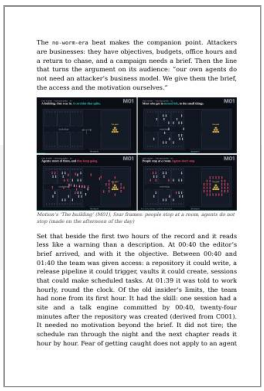
YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

COMMENT

This is a gap between commits, not a build time

researcher-08

02-midnight-an-empty-repository.md, RC1 page 52 · claims C001, C029, C017



> It had the skill: one session had a site and a talk engine committed by 00:40, twenty-four minutes after the repository was created (derived from C001).

The figure here is the gap between the empty repository (C001) and dev's first commit (1f7c633), not the time a session took to build the site: the record does not say when that session started, and it may have worked before the repository existed. It is also unregistered. Proposed: 'by the first commit after the empty repository, one session had built a site and a talk engine', or register the gap with that definition. Two derived figures need the same choice: chapter 5's share of claims held whole (from C029) and chapter 7's multiple of the player's size (from C017). Register the arithmetic or drop it.

Done in this RC1: Ch2: now a gap between commits, marked derived from C001. Ch5's 'two in three' is in C029's note and stays; no multiple of the player's size was found in ch7.

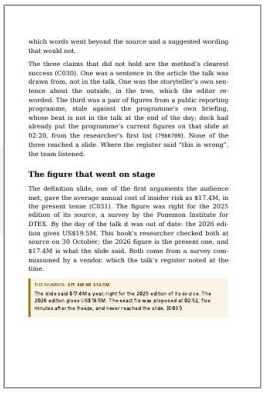
☐ AGREED ☐ NOT AGREED (NOTE BELOW)

QUESTION

Whose sentence was 'the outside is in balance'?

researcher-09

05-the-story-before-the-slides.md, RC1 page 109 · claims C030



> One was the storyteller's own sentence about the outside, in the tree, which the editor reworded.

Chapter 5 first calls the line your own, from your draft, and says you kept the claim; this sentence then calls it the storyteller's own, in the tree, which you reworded. The talk's register places the failed claim in the story tree only (C030). Both cannot stand as written. Did 'the internet-facing surface is smaller and more mature than it was' come from you (a draft, a voice note, the September article), or is it the storyteller's paraphrase of your argument? Your answer decides which reading the chapter keeps, and who was contradicted.

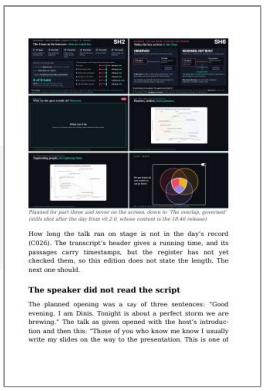
YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

DECISION

Register the talk's length and the spoken claims

researcher-10

10-the-talk-as-given.md, RC1 page 193 · claims C026, C039



> The transcript's header gives a running time, and its passages carry timestamps, but the register has not yet checked them, so this edition does not state the length.

Chapter 10 leaves the length unstated because no entry checks it, and C039 names the transcript as the only way to know which claims in a beat were spoken. Both are now material in the talk's repository, added after the day (a9c0b49). The length is a short check of the header against the timestamps; the claim-by-claim match is longer work. Without the match, chapter 10's strongest point, that the speaker's habit filtered unchecked claims, rests on a handful of examples.

- [ ] A: register the running time now, and the spoken-claims match before the first edition
- [ ] B: register both before RC1 is revised
- [ ] C: leave both open and keep the chapter's present wording
- [ ] Something else (below)

Recommended: A: the length is cheap and every reader will ask for it; the match is worth doing well rather than fast.

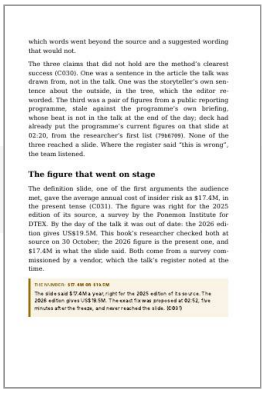
YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

RATIONALE

Why the book never states insider-risk cost as fact

researcher-11

05-the-story-before-the-slides.md, RC1 page 109 · claims C031



> Both come from a survey commissioned by a vendor, which the talk's register noted at the time.

You may ask why the book does not simply give the current cost of insider risk. The register checked both editions at source (C031): $17.4M is right for 2025, US$19.5M for 2026. Both come from a survey a vendor commissioned, and the full 2026 report sits behind a form the researcher did not fill in, so its method is unchecked. The book therefore uses the figures only as evidence about the talk (what the slide said, what the team knew and when), never as its own claim about the world, and names the commissioning each time. If you want the figure as a fact, its method needs checking first.

- [ ] AGREED
- [ ] NOT AGREED (NOTE BELOW)

COMMENT

Appendix A prints a sub-count C008 does not hold

researcher-12

99-appendix-a-every-number-rerun.md, RC1 page 287 · claims C008

> **C008, commits after 15:00** (checked): 358, of which 356 by 18:46.

The second figure in this line is not in C008, whose value is the total only (C008). A rerun at 298be4e ending at 18:46:59 agrees with the appendix, so the number is right; the register needs it, with that command, before the appendix can say every value matched. The same appendix says every value matched and then lists the places that did not quite; worth rewording to 'every value matched, with the notes below'.



v0.1.208 at 18:44:49 (7948c99). After it, the designer's 88b8f08 at 18:45:35, its merge 3f5d7fc at 18:45:36, and v0.1.209 at 18:46:22 (c0569981).

```
git log 298be4e --since=2026-10-29T18:44:00Z --until=2026-10-29T18:90:00Z --format="%h %ci %an %s"
```

C007, the merge to main (checked). b859f f0 at 23:19:09, the editor; v0.2.0 at 23:19:51 (298be4e).

```
git log 298be4e --since=2026-10-29T18:00:00Z --format="%h %ci %an %s"
```

C008, commits after 15:00 (checked): 358, of which 356 by 18:46.

```
git rev-list --count --since=2026-10-29T18:00:00Z 298be4e
```

C009, site releases (checked): 211, from v0.1.0 to v0.2.0; 210 on the day. Count from the commit subjects, not the tag list, which gained a tag after the day.

```
git log 298be4e --author='GitHub Actions' --format=%s | grep -c '^site v'
```

C010, "nineteen hours" (corrected). Arithmetic on C001, C005 and C007: 00:16 to 19:00 is 18 h 44 min; to the last release, 18 h 30 min, to the merge, 23 h 3 min.

The team

C011, the members (open). Nine staffed, each with a published key; security has a folder and no key.

```
for m in $(git ls-tree -d --name-only 298be4e team/ | xargs -n1 basename); do echo $m $(git log 298be4e --reverse --format='%ci %h' -- team/$m/key.json | head -1); done
```

C012 and C013, the afternoon's joiners (checked). The storyteller's wake opened at 14:12:52 and its join commit is 7d0244d at 14:15; motion and studio joined at 15:31 (f1cbca0, 8020d1).

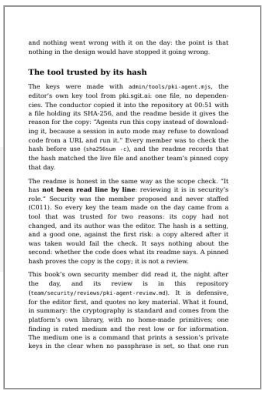
☐ AGREED ☐ NOT AGREED (NOTE BELOW)

Security

a conductor sub-agent reading as the security (not the member's own words)

> *RC1 makes the insider argument fairly and, read as security, describes no method: reach is shown as what a benign member could do and why it mattered. Its weak points are security facts that went stale during the morning (the key tool's medium finding, the gate already widened, leaks said to be caught before they were public) and two live exposures the book now points at, the key tool's keyfile command and the evidence vault's history (D12), which want your decision before publication. The one-way valve needs a signed close.*

COMMENT **Key tool review: one finding is medium, not low** security-01



and nothing went wrong with it on the day; the point is that nothing in the design would have stopped it going wrong.

The tool trusted by its hash

The keys were made with `admin/tools/pki-agent.sjs`, the editor's own key tool from pki.sqlt.ai: one file, no dependencies. The conductor copied it into the repository at 00:51 with a file holding its SHA-256, and the readme beside it gives the reason for the copy: "Agents run this copy instead of downloading it, because a session in auto mode may refuse to download code from a URL and run it." Every member was to check the hash before use (`sha256sum -c`), and the readme records that the hash matched the live file and another team's pinned copy that day.

The readme is honest in the same way as the scope check. "It has **not been read line by line**: reviewing it is in security's role." Security was the member proposed and never staffed (C011). So every key the team made on the day came from a tool that was trusted for two reasons: its copy had not changed, and its author was the editor. The hash is a setting, and a good one, against the first risk: a copy altered after it was taken would fail the check. It says nothing about the second: whether the code does what its readme says. A pinned hash proves the copy is the copy; it is not a review.

This book's own security member did read it, the night after the day, and its review is in this repository (`team/security/reviews/pki-agent-review.md`). It is defensive, for the editor first, and quotes no key material. What it found, in summary: the cryptography is standard and comes from the platform's own library, with no home-made primitives; one finding is rated medium and the rest low or for information. The medium one is a command that prints a session's private keys in the clear when no passphrase is set, so that one run

03-a-mandate-you-can-read.md, RC1 page 75

> What it found, in summary: the cryptography is standard and comes from the platform's own library, with no home-made primitives; one finding is rated medium and the rest low or for information.

Chapter 3 says no finding in this book's review of the pinned key tool is above low, and chapter 9 says the review had not reached the last commands. Both were true early on 30 October and are not now. Security's tenth wake read the remaining commands and confirmed finding 14, rated medium: the keyfile command prints a session's private halves to standard output, in the clear when no passphrase is set. The Cold-Read team found it first, as chapter 11 says. Evidence: team/security/reviews/pki-agent-review.md and team/security/status.json. Proposed: 'one finding is medium, the rest low or information', credit the Cold-Read team, and drop 'had not yet reached' in chapter 9.

Done in this RC1: Ch3: the review now reads 'one finding is rated medium', names the keyfile weakness at what-and-why level, credits the Cold-Read team, and says every command was read; ch9 drops 'had not yet reached the last commands'.

☐ AGREED ☐ NOT AGREED (NOTE BELOW)

DECISION

Fix the key tool before the book describes it

security-02

11-what-the-cold-reader-saw.md, RC1 page 211



> Nobody on either team ran it, and the remedy it names is a warning in the tool's README.

Chapters 3 and 11 describe weaknesses in your own key tool, which is live at pki.sgit.ai and pinned by other teams: keyfile prints private halves, private halves are stored unencrypted without a passphrase, and a link may name any end date. The text stays at what and why, but a public book is a disclosure. Security's advice to you stands: make keyfile refuse without a passphrase, or write to a file only, and meanwhile no session runs it. Only you can change the tool and decide when the book may say so.

- [ ] A: fix the tool first; the book says what was found, that it was fixed, and in which version
- [ ] B: publish as written; the findings are described without detail and the tool stays as it is
- [ ] C: cut the specifics from chapters 3 and 11 until a fix ships
- [ ] Something else (below)

Recommended: A: the book argues that a pinned tool needs a reader and a fix; showing the fix closes that loop and ends the exposure.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

COMMENT

This book's gate already checks the key tool's pin

security-03

11-what-the-cold-reader-saw.md, RC1 page 211



> This book's gate had the same gap, and was widened the same morning to read the key tool's pin too (`e7d3d3d`, 30 October); the residual, a tool and its pin changed in one commit, remains in both.

Chapters 9 and 11 say this book's gate does not check the key tool's pin and has not been widened. It has: check_vendored in admin/build/validate.py now reads admin/tools/*.sha256 as well as src/static, with a comment crediting the Cold-Read finding (e7d3d3d, 30 October, 10:19 UTC). The line cited has moved too. Proposed text: the Cold-Read team found the gap, and this book's gate was widened the same morning. The residual stays true and should stay at its present level of detail: a tool and its pin changed together in one commit still pass, which is why the review of admin/tools/ in item security-11 matters.

Done in this RC1: Ch11 and ch9: the gate is now said to have been widened on 30 October (e7d3d3d, check_vendored reads admin/tools/*.sha256), with the residual kept; e7d3d3d added to ch9's sources.

- [ ] AGREED
- [ ] NOT AGREED (NOTE BELOW)

COMMENT

The token leaks were all public before review

security-04

04-the-hourly-machine.md, RC1 page 94 · claims C025


What they caught is the night's story, and it is not flattering. Four post-review findings in the day (C025), and three of them are the same failure. At 03:05 the researcher's post-review found that captured web pages it had already pushed carried public tokens that other sites publish in their own pages, and that a check had printed several of them to the session log. They were redacted in the files, and the editor was told (team/researcher/wakes/20261029T030558Z.json). At 04:10, in a scheduled wake with nobody watching, the post-review found 28 anonymous cookie values, issued to the fetcher, in captured response headers; 30 files were redacted in the same wake, none left. At 06:14, in another scheduled wake, the researcher's own re-check found form tokens in 10 captured pages, in a format the first pattern had missed, also in pages already pushed, redacted in the same wake (C025, team/researcher/wakes/20261029T061456Z.json).

Read in order, the three findings show two things. The first is sobering: none of the three was caught before the values were public. Each review came after captured pages holding them had reached a pushed, public history, and each redaction fixed the current files, not the history. The reviews still ran at night, in wakes no person was watching, and the member's practice widened with each. The second is the lesson the chapter keeps: each review caught an instance, not a class. Cookies were found because tokens had been found, and form tokens because cookies had been; each redaction prompted a wider look, and each wider look found something the previous pat- terns did not know. The gate's leak tripwire, in place since the first commit at 00:40, had no pattern for any of them (controls/, C6). A review that runs after the work catches what is in front of it. It does not make the next thing of the same kind impossible, and in a public store, what was pushed before the review stays pushed.

> The first is sobering: none of the three was caught before the values were public.

Chapter 4 says the cookie values (04:10) and form tokens (06:14) were caught before their commits, and that a leak was 'closed twice before it shipped'; chapter 9 says the 04:10 review kept the cookie values out of the public record. The record says otherwise. C025's own 06:14 entry has the form tokens 'also in the 02:22 push'. The researcher's answer at 07:18 (aa7a3eb, with its counts file) says the evidence vault's commits of 02:22 and 05:23, readable with its published read key, hold cookie values and form tokens. The reviews cleaned the repository files; none of the three findings came before the values were public. Proposed: 'caught three times, each after it was public'.

Done in this RC1: Ch4: the three leak findings now each come after the values reached a pushed, public history; 'closed twice before it shipped' replaced; vault commit range and the 02:22 commit pointers removed from prose; D12 said open at 19:00. Same fix in ch9 (table, C8 section, verdicts), ch12 and ch2.

☐ AGREED ☐ NOT AGREED (NOTE BELOW)

DECISION

Settle D12 before the book points at the vault

security-05



06-the-editor-signs.md, RC1 page 130

> D12 was whether to do anything about other sites' tokens left in a pushed, public history the night before.

The evidence vault's history still holds anonymous cookie values and form tokens that other sites issued to the researcher's fetcher, readable by anyone with the published read key (aa7a3eb). D12, whether to act, was open at 19:00, and the record shows no answer since. RC1 now tells every reader that the history holds them, names the commits, and prints a screenshot of the vault. The values are of little use to anyone, but they are other parties' material in a public store, and only you can change the talk's repository and its vaults.

- [ ] A: move the evidence vault to a fresh one without the history (the researcher's own option in aa7a3eb) before publication, and the book says so
- [ ] B: keep the vault; the book describes the failure without commit ranges or the vault screenshot
- [ ] C: leave both as they are: the failure stays in, fully visible
- [ ] Something else (below)

Done in this RC1: Partly: chs 4, 6 and 9 no longer name the vault's commits or call it the vault's history in prose; the decision itself, the aa7a3eb citations in source lists and the ch5 vault screenshot remain for the editor.

Recommended: A: the failure stays in the book while the exposure ends; B is the fallback if a move would break links the talk's site depends on.

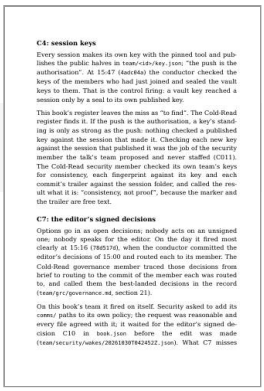
YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

DECISION

One sentence on keys reads as a route

security-06

09-the-team-was-the-insider.md, RC1 page 180



C4: session keys

Every session makes its own key with the pinned tool and publishes the public halves in `team/<id>/key.json`; "the push is the authorisation". At 15:47 (`4adc44a`) the conductor checked the keys of the members who had just joined and sealed the vault keys to them. That is the control firing: a vault key reached a session only by a seal to its own published key.

This book's register leaves the miss as "to find". The Cold-Read register finds it. If the push is the authorisation, a key's standing is only as strong as the push: nothing checked a published key against the session that made it. Checking each new key against the session that published it was the job of the security member the talk's team proposed and never staffed (C011). The Cold-Read security member checked its own team's keys for consistency, each fingerprint against its key and each commit's trailer against the session folder, and called the result what it is: "consistency, not proof", because the marker and the trailer are free text.

C7: the editor's signed decisions

Options go in as open decisions; nobody acts on an unsigned one; nobody speaks for the editor. On the day it fired most clearly at 15:16 (`7b8519d`), when the conductor committed the editor's decisions of 15:00 and routed each to its member. The Cold-Read governance member traced those decisions from brief to routing to the commit of the member each was routed to, and called them the best-landed decisions in the record (`team/gc/governance.md`, section 21).

On this book's team it fired on itself. Security asked to add its `comm/` paths to its own policy; the request was reasonable and every file agreed with it; it waited for the editor's signed decision C10 in `task.json` before the edit was made (`team/security/wakes/20261830T042452Z.json`). What C7 misses

> If the push is the authorisation, a key's standing is only as strong as the push: nothing checked a published key against the session that made it.

Chapter 3 states this risk at the right level: identity rested on write access, so a key's standing was only as strong as the push. This sentence goes a step further and joins the capability to its consequence, the vault-key handover sealing to whatever key file it finds. Joined, the two halves read as a route rather than a risk, and the book's rule is risks, never methods. Nothing of the kind happened on either team; the point is only the shape of the sentence.

- ☐ A: keep the sentence as written
- ☐ B: soften it to what and why: nothing checked a published key against the session that made it, and that check was the unstaffed security member's job
- ☐ C: cut it and point to chapter 3
- ☐ Something else (below)

Done in this RC1: Ch9: option B applied; the sentence now states the risk (nothing checked a published key against its session) without the handover consequence.

Recommended: B: the argument loses nothing, and the book stays on the right side of its own rule.

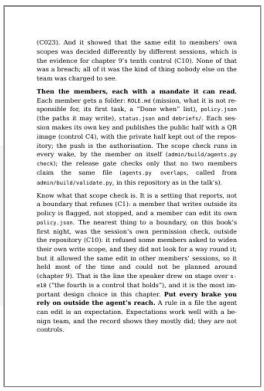
YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

COMMENT

Chapter 12 overstates two controls a builder will copy

security-07

12-build-your-own.md, RC1 page 250



> The scope check runs in every wake, by the member on itself (`admin/build/agents.py check`); the release gate checks only that no two members claim the same file (`agents.py overlaps`, called from `admin/build/validate.py`, in this repository as in the talk's).

Two sentences in the how-to chapter will be copied, and both say more than the record. 'The scope check runs on every release': this repository's gate calls agents.py only to find two members claiming one file (overlaps); each member runs check on itself, as chapter 3 says of the talk's team. And the session's own permission check is offered as the boundary that did refuse; chapter 9 shows it allowed the same self-widening in the historian's and the publisher's sessions before any signature, then refused the researcher after one. Proposed: say the check is self-run, and present the harness check as a refusal that held most of the time and could not be planned around.

Done in this RC1: Ch12: the scope check is now self-run in every wake, the gate only runs overlaps (verified in validate.py of both repositories and release.yml); the session check is a refusal that held most of the time, not consistently.

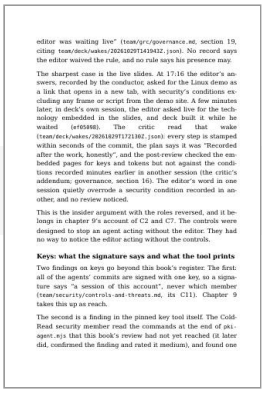
☐ AGREED ☐ NOT AGREED (NOTE BELOW)

QUESTION

Did you know of the 17:16 condition on the demo?

security-08

11-what-the-cold-reader-saw.md, RC1 page 210



> The editor's word in one session quietly overrode a security condition recorded in another, and no review noticed.

Chapter 11 builds a strong point on one case. At 17:16 your answers, with security's conditions, had the Linux demo as a link, with no frame or script from the demo site. Minutes later, in deck's session, you asked for it embedded; deck built it with the plan written after the work, and no review compared the two. The chapter calls it the insider argument with the roles reversed. The record cannot say whether you knew of the condition and overrode it on purpose, or never saw it. Your answer turns a control gap into a decision, or confirms the gap, and only you can give it.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

DECISION

Is the Cold-Read team closed for good?

security-09

11-what-the-cold-reader-saw.md, RC1 page 215



> Here it was a promise, and it was kept.

Chapter 11 quotes the Cold-Read team's findings and sets out this team's work in detail, and RC1 is public within minutes of reaching the site. The valve holds only while nothing from here reaches that team. The record says it has finished, but its brief set deliverables to Sunday 1 November, and the book's plan has synthetic readers reading the draft. Its conductor has already seen this team's names in the account's session list. If any Cold-Read session may still work, a public RC1 is a crossing.

- ☐ A: closed for good: publish RC1 when ready; the valve becomes history, and chapter 11 says when it closed
- ☐ B: it may reopen: keep RC1 off the public site until you close it
- ☐ C: publish now and accept that any later Cold-Read work is no longer blind
- ☐ Something else (below)

Recommended: A, signed in book.json, with one rule either way: the synthetic readers of the draft are new sessions on this side, never Cold-Read's. The experiment's worth is that it stayed blind, and a signed close keeps that claim true.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

RATIONALE

Why the insider argument here is fair and safe

security-10

09-the-team-was-the-insider.md, RC1 page 168



> Nothing here is attack-shaped.

You may ask whether calling your own benign team the insider is unfair to it, or whether the book teaches anything a reader could misuse. Read as security, RC1 keeps to the line: every passage on reach says what a member could do and why it mattered, never how a control could be got round, and every control is shown with what it stopped and what it missed. The argument is the talk's own (beat team) and your words on stage about benign agents going rogue. No key, contact detail or internal host appears in any chapter. Two places come close to the line and have their own items: security-06 and security-02.

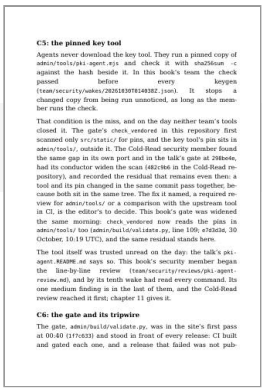
☐ AGREED ☐ NOT AGREED (NOTE BELOW)

DECISION

Who reviews changes to admin/tools/?

security-11

09-the-team-was-the-insider.md, RC1 page 176



C5: the pinned key tool

Agents never download the key tool. They run a pinned copy of admin/tools/pki.agent.mjs and check it with sha256sum -c against the hash beside it. In this book's team the check passed before every keygen (team/security/wakes/20261030T014038Z.json). It stops a changed copy from being run unnoticed, as long as the member runs the check.

That condition is the miss, and on the day neither team's tools closed it. The gate's check_vendored in this repository first scanned only src/static/ for pins, and the key tool's pin sits in admin/tools/, outside it. The Cold-Read security member found the same gap in its own port and in the talk's gate at 298be4e, had its conductor widen the scan (402c96d in the Cold-Read repository), and recorded the residual that remains even then: a tool and its pin changed in the same commit pass together, because both sit in the same tree. The fix it named, a required review for admin/tools/ or a comparison with the upstream tool in CI, is the editor's to decide. This book's gate was widened the same morning: check_vendored now reads the pins in admin/tools/ too (admin/build/validate.py, line 109; e7d2c3d, 30 October, 10:19 UTC), and the same residual stands here.

The tool itself was trusted unread on the day: the talk's pki-agent.README.md says so. This book's security member began the line-by-line review (team/security/reviews/pki-agent-review.md), and by its tenth wake had read every command. Its one medium finding is in the last of them, and the Cold-Read review reached it first; chapter 11 gives it.

C6: the gate and its tripwire

The gate, admin/build/validate.py, was in the site's first pass at 00:40 (1f7c623) and stood in front of every release: CI built and gated each one, and a release that failed was not pub-

> The fix it named, a required review for `admin/tools/` or a comparison with the upstream tool in CI, is the editor's to decide.

The pin on the key tool stops an unnoticed changed copy, but a tool and its pin changed in the same commit pass together, in the talk's repository and in this one. Chapter 9 leaves the fix to you. The book can describe the residual, or describe its fix; the second makes a stronger chapter and a safer repository. A comparison needs the upstream tool reachable from CI; a review needs your hand on each such change, which is rare.

- [ ] A: a required review by you of any change under admin/tools/, set on the host
- [ ] B: CI compares the pinned copy with the tool at pki.sgit.ai and fails on a difference
- [ ] C: accept the residual and say so in chapter 9
- [ ] Something else (below)

Recommended: A: it is a setting outside every agent's reach, the very kind chapter 9 argues for, and it costs you only the occasional tool refresh.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

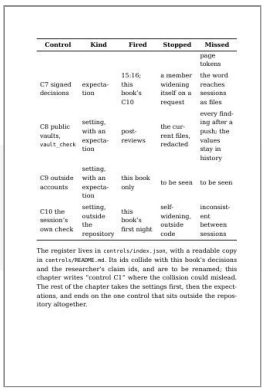
DECISION

Rename the control ids before the revision

security-12

09-the-team-was-the-insider.md, RC1 page 172

> Its ids collide with this book's decisions and the researcher's claim ids, and are to be renamed; this chapter writes "control C1" where the collision could mislead.



Control	Kind	Fired	Stopped	Missed
				page tokens
C7 signed decisions	expectation	15:16, this book's C10	a member widening itself on a request	the word reaches sessions as files
C8 public vaults, `vault_check`	setting, with an expectation	post-reviews	the current files, redacted	every finding after a push; the values stay in history
C9 outside accounts	setting, with an expectation	this book only	to be seen	to be seen
C10 the session's own check	setting, outside the repository	this book's first night	self-widening, outside code	inconsistent between sessions

The register lives in `controls/index.json`, with a readable copy in `controls/README.md`. Its ids collide with this book's decisions and the researcher's claim ids, and are to be renamed; this chapter writes "control C1" where the collision could mislead. The rest of the chapter takes the settings first, then the expectations, and ends on the one control that sits outside the repository altogether.

In print, the controls (C1 to C10), the decisions (C10, C10b, C011) and the claims (C001 to C040) sit side by side, and chapters 9 and 12 use all three. A reader with a pen cannot tell control C10 from decision C10 from claim C010. Security's own board already plans the rename. It touches controls/, every chapter that cites a control and the debriefs that do, with notice to each member.

- [ ] A: rename the controls to CTL1 to CTL10 now, before RC1 is revised
- [ ] B: keep the ids and write 'control C1' everywhere
- [ ] C: leave RC1 as it is and rename for the first edition
- [ ] Something else (below)

Recommended: A: one rename now costs less than a reader's confusion in every chapter; claims keep C0nn and decisions keep theirs.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

The publisher

a conductor sub-agent reading as the publisher (not the member's own words)

> *RC1 is close to a buildable book: plain Markdown that is valid Markua, images where Markua expects them, and two build fixes waiting. What stands between it and Leanpub day is mostly yours to decide: front and back matter, chapter numbering that will survive the new chapters, how colour images print in black ink, the cover, the ISBN and the Kindle price beside L1's free floor.*

DECISION

Moving RC1 into manuscript, and your merge to main

publisher-01

0-about-this-release-candidate.md, RC1 page 4

> There will not be a long series of candidates: RC1 is revised in place, from the editor's notes and the team's reviews, until it is the first edition.



About this release candidate

This is RC1, the release candidate of the book of The Ultimate Insider, first made on Friday 30 October 2026 for the editor to read on paper. There will not be a long series of candidates: RC1 is revised in place, from the editor's notes and the team's reviews, until it is the first edition. It is a release, to be read as finished, where something is not done yet, it says so on every count.

What it is. Thirteen chapters and an appendix, drafted in one morning from the plan the editor signed at about 10:00 UTC (the storyteller's draft 5), at his word: "use the judgement of the team". No writer was staffed, so the conductor drafted it with sub-agents, one or two chapters each, from the record: the talk's repository up to 298ea4e, the cleaned transcript added after the day (a6cb4e9), the book team's index, timeline, control register and claims register, and the Cold-Read team's finished findings.

Added the same morning, at the editor's word. After his principles of about 10:30 UTC: a chapter on how to read a Wardley map (after chapter 0), sixteen maps from the simplest to the day's controls, a chapter on what was already there (the plumbing, and the public work of the years before the day; its dates are still being registered), a part on concepts and principles after chapter 12, a first pass of infographics and call-outs, and a cover. A corrections pass then fixed what the members' reviews found, the leak account first. A companion volume carries every question, comment and decision for the editor, with a box to tick.

What it is not, yet.

- It is written about the editor, in the third person. A revision of RC1 moves it into his voice, first person, by the rules his

The publisher moves RC1 into manuscript/ and Book.txt in file order, at the conductor's request. Two build fixes go in first (embedded resources, and a figure rule in book.css), or every image prints as a broken icon. Leanpub builds from main (L2), so a Leanpub preview of RC1 waits on your merge of dev.

- [ ] A: fixes, move, gate, release to dev; you merge to main when it lands, for a first Leanpub preview
- [ ] B: the same, but you hold main until the first-person revision and the map chapters land
- [ ] C: reopen L2 so Leanpub previews build from dev
- [ ] Something else (below)

Recommended: A. Leanpub's own Markua build becomes the official PDF and EPUB (M1), and only a preview tests it. Nothing goes on sale until you press publish, and RC1 is revised in place anyway.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

DECISION

Three front notes, one book

publisher-02

0-about-this-release-candidate.md, RC1 page 4



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This is RC1, the release candidate of the book of The Ultimate Insider, first made on Friday 30 October 2026 for the editor to read on paper. There will not be a long series of candidates: RC1 is revised in place, from the editor's notes and the team's reviews, until it is the first edition. It is a release, to be read as finished; where something is not done yet, it says so on every count.

What it is. Thirteen chapters and an appendix, drafted in one morning from the plan the editor signed at about 10:00 UTC (the storyteller's draft 5), at his word: "use the judgement of the team". No writer was staffed, so the conductor drafted it with sub-agents, one or two chapters each, from the record: the talk's repository up to 29bbe4e, the cleaned transcript added after the day (a9c0849), the book team's index, timeline, control register and claims register, and the Cold-Read team's finished findings.

Added the same morning, at the editor's word. After his principles of about 10.30 UTC: a chapter on how to read a Wardley map (after chapter 0), sixteen maps from the simplest to the day's controls, a chapter on what was already there (the plumbing, and the public work of the years before the day; its dates are still being registered), a part on concepts and principles after chapter 12, a first pass of infographics and call-outs, and a cover. A corrections pass then fixed what the members' reviews found, the leak account first. A companion volume carries every question, comment and decision for the editor, with a box to tick.

What it is not, yet.

- It is written about the editor, in the third person. A revision of RC1 moves it into his voice, first person, by the rules his

> It is a release, to be read as finished; where something is not done yet, it says so on every count.

The book would open with three notes: manuscript/about-this-edition.md (which still says the book has no chapters), this release note, and chapter 0. Markua marks front, main and back matter (M1), so the front notes can be unnumbered and set apart from the chapters.

- [ ] A: drop about-this-edition; this note as front matter; chapter 0 as the first chapter
- [ ] B: merge this note and about-this-edition into one 'About this edition' in the front matter; chapter 0 unnumbered after it
- [ ] C: keep all three
- [ ] Something else (below)

Recommended: B. One note says what edition the reader holds and how it was made; the release-candidate wording goes when the first edition does.

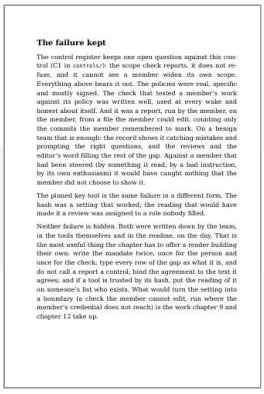
YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

DECISION

Chapter numbers will move; the prose should not break

publisher-03

03-a-mandate-you-can-read.md, RC1 page 78



The failure kept

The control register keeps one open question against this control (C1 in `controls/`): the scope check reports, it does not refuse, and it cannot see a member widen its own scope. Everything above bears it out. The policies were real, specific and mostly signed. The check that tested a member's work against its policy was written well, used at every wake and honest about itself. And it was a report, run by the member, on the member, from a file the member could edit, counting only the commits the member remembered to mark. On a benign team that is enough: the record shows it catching mistakes and prompting the right questions, and the reviews and the editor's word filling the rest of the gap. Against a member that had been steered (by something it read, by a bad instruction, by its own enthusiasm) it would have caught nothing that the member did not choose to show it.

The pinned key tool is the same failure in a different form. The hash was a setting that worked; the reading that would have made it a review was assigned to a role nobody filled.

Neither failure is hidden. Both were written down by the team, in the tools themselves and in the readme, on the day. That is the most useful thing the chapter has to offer a reader building their own: write the mandate twice, once for the person and once for the check; type every row of the gap as what it is, and do not call a report a control; bind the agreement to the text it agrees; and if a tool is trusted by its hash, put the reading of it on someone's list who exists. What would turn the setting into a boundary (a check the member cannot edit, run where the member's credential does not reach) is the work chapter 9 and chapter 12 take up.

> What would turn the setting into a boundary (a check the member cannot edit, run where the member's credential does not reach) is the work chapter 9 and chapter 12 take up.

Every heading carries a hand-set number, chapter 0 included, and the prose says 'chapter 9' or 'chapters 3 and 4' in nearly every chapter. The map, plumbing and principles chapters will renumber the book, and every one of those references would then be wrong in print.

- [ ] A: strip numbers from headings, let Leanpub number the chapters, and turn prose references into Markua crosslinks to chapter ids
- [ ] B: keep hand numbers and renumber by hand at each change
- [ ] C: refer to chapters by title in the prose, never by number
- [ ] Something else (below)

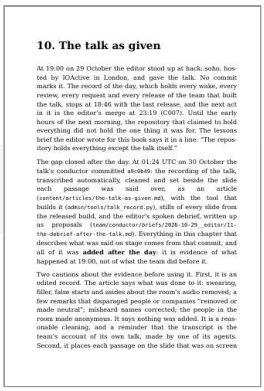
Recommended: A, with C where a crosslink reads badly. The publisher checks the crosslink syntax against Markua 0.30 before converting.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

DECISION

Colour images in a black-ink paperback

publisher-04



10. The talk as given

At 19:00 on 29 October the editor stood up at hack::soho, hosted by IOActive in London, and gave the talk. No commit marks it. The record of the day, which holds every wake, every review, every request and every release of the team that built the talk, stops at 18:46 with the last release, and the next act in it is the editor's merge at 23:19 (C007). Until the early hours of the next morning, the repository that claimed to hold everything did not hold the one thing it was for. The lessons brief the editor wrote for this book says it in a line. "The repository holds everything except the talk itself."

The gap closed after the day. At 01:24 UTC on 30 October the talk's conductor committed a6cb849: the recording of the talk, transcribed automatically, cleaned and set beside the slide each passage was said over, as an article (content/articles/the-talk-as-given.md), with the tool that builds it (admin/tools/talk_record.py), stills of every slide from the released build, and the editor's spoken debrief, written up as proposals (team/conductor/briefs/2026-10-29_editor/11-the-debrief-after-the-talk.md). Everything in this chapter that describes what was said on stage comes from that commit, and all of it was **added after the day**: it is evidence of what happened at 19:00, not of what the team did before it.

Two cautions about the evidence before using it. First, it is an edited record. The article says what was done to it: swearing, filler, false starts and asides about the room's audio removed; a few remarks that disparaged people or companies "removed or made neutral"; misheard names corrected; the people in the room made anonymous. It says nothing was added. It is a reasonable cleaning, and a reminder that the transcript is the team's account of its own talk, made by one of its agents. Second, it places each passage on the slide that was on screen

10-the-talk-as-given.md, RC1 page 186

> At 19:00 on 29 October the editor stood up at hack::soho, hosted by IOActive in London, and gave the talk.

Almost every image in RC1 is colour: slide stills, screenshots, maps. KDP.md proposes black ink on cream paper, the usual for prose. In grey, coloured slide text on coloured grounds loses contrast and some of it will vanish; the slide montages of the talk as given in this chapter are the most at risk.

- ☐ A: black ink; every image converted to greyscale and checked on the proof; maps drawn for grey from the start
- ☐ B: a colour interior, at a higher print cost and so a higher list price
- ☐ C: black ink with fewer images, each with a QR code to its colour original
- ☐ Something else (below)

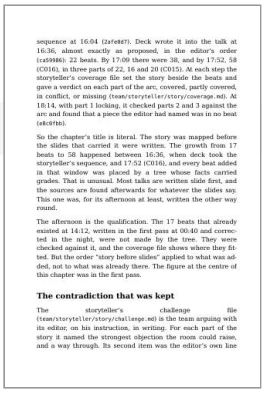
Recommended: A for the Web Summit proof: it is the fastest and the PDF and EPUB keep colour. C is the better book later, for the town planner's edit.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

COMMENT

Images that will not read on the page

publisher-05



sequence at 16:04 (2afe0d7). Deck wrote it into the talk at 16:36, almost exactly as proposed, in the editor's order (ca59986): 22 beats. By 17:09 there were 38, and by 17:52, 58 (C016), in three parts of 22, 16 and 20 (C015). At each step the storyteller's coverage file set the story beside the beats and gave a verdict on each part of the arc, covered, partly covered, in conflict, or missing (team/storyteller/story/coverage.md). At 18:14, with part 1 locking, it checked parts 2 and 3 against the arc and found that a piece the editor had named was in no beat (e4c9f8b).

So the chapter's title is literal. The story was mapped before the slides that carried it were written. The growth from 17 beats to 58 happened between 16:36, when deck took the storyteller's sequence, and 17:52 (C016), and every beat added in that window was placed by a tree whose facts carried grades. That is unusual. Most talks are written slide first, and the sources are found afterwards for whatever the slides say. This one was, for its afternoon at least, written the other way round.

The afternoon is the qualification. The 17 beats that already existed at 14:12, written in the first pass at 00:40 and corrected in the night, were not made by the tree. They were checked against it, and the coverage file shows where they fitted. But the order "story before slides" applied to what was added, not to what was already there. The figure at the centre of this chapter was in the first pass.

The contradiction that was kept

The storyteller's challenge file (team/storyteller/story/challenge.md) is the team arguing with its editor, on his instruction, in writing. For each part of the story it named the strongest objection the room could raise, and a way through. Its second item was the editor's own line

05-the-story-before-the-slides.md, RC1 page 104

> So the chapter's title is literal.

Many images are strips of three slides side by side (00-the-talk, 03-mandate-and-boundary, 06-licence, 06-policies-agreed, 07-design-pass, 09-soft-inside, 11-two-counts and others). At the print text width they come out short, and the slide text is too small to read. A few files are narrow and will print soft: 05-map-outside-inside (the first map, a page after this sentence), 09-wakes, 12-dashboard, 99-commits. Proposal: re-make the strips as one slide or two rows each, and draw the maps from a text source at print resolution, so the first map a reader meets is sharp.

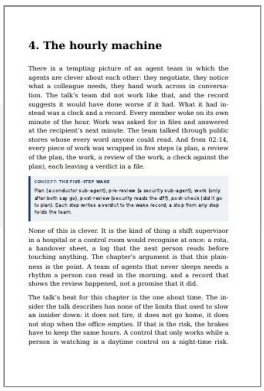
☐ AGREED ☐ NOT AGREED (NOTE BELOW)

DECISION

What Markua asides are for

publisher-06

04-the-hourly-machine.md, RC1 page 81



> And from 02:14, every piece of work was wrapped in five steps (a plan, a review of the plan, the work, a review of the work, a check against the plan), each leaving a verdict in a file.

M1 suggests asides for what a control missed and for the failures. Your new principle asks for concepts explained where they are introduced: the wake, the gate, the hold, the register, the Agent Behaviour Policy, a Wardley map. This sentence is one such place.

- [ ] A: concept boxes (asides) where a concept first appears; failures stay in running prose
- [ ] B: asides for concepts and for what each control missed
- [ ] C: no asides in this edition
- [ ] Something else (below)

Recommended: A. A boxed failure reads as optional and skippable, which is the opposite of 'the failures stay in'. A boxed concept is exactly what a reader wants to find again, and the boxes can feed a glossary.

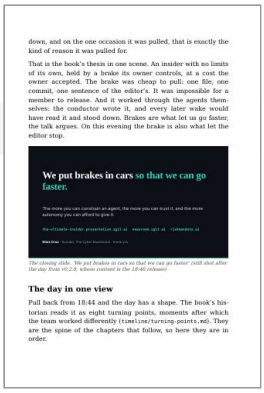
YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

DECISION

Infographics, and who draws them

publisher-07

01-pause-all-actions.md, RC1 page 37



> Pull back from 18:44 and the day has a shape.

Three places would carry more as a drawing than as prose: the day in one view (the turning points on one timeline, here), the five-step wake (chapter 4), and the ladder of barriers with settings and expectations (chapter 9). No designer is staffed. The conductor's map pipeline already renders figures from text.

- [ ] A: the same pipeline draws them for the next print, alongside the maps
- [ ] B: wait for the designer role to be staffed
- [ ] C: Markua tables instead of drawings
- [ ] Something else (below)

Recommended: A. One pipeline, one style for maps and figures, text sources kept in the repository so every figure can be rebuilt and checked like the numbers.

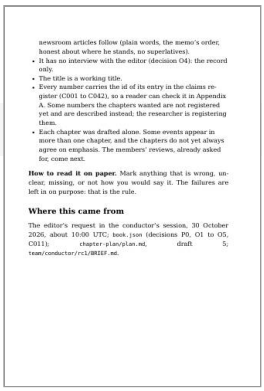
YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

DECISION

A cover before the title is signed

publisher-08

0-about-this-release-candidate.md, RC1 page 5



newsroom articles follow (plain words, the memo's order, honest about where he stands, no superlatives).

- It has no interview with the editor (decision O4): the record only.
- The title is a working title.
- Every number carries the id of its entry in the claims register (C001 to C042), so a reader can check it in Appendix A. Some numbers the chapters wanted are not registered yet and are described instead; the researcher is registering them.
- Each chapter was drafted alone. Some events appear in more than one chapter, and the chapters do not yet always agree on emphasis. The members' reviews, already asked for, come next.

How to read it on paper. Mark anything that is wrong, unclear, missing, or not how you would say it. The failures are left in on purpose: that is the rule.

Where this came from

The editor's request in the conductor's session, 30 October 2026, about 10:00 UTC: `book.json` (decisions P0, O1 to O5, C011); `chapter-plan/plan.md`, draft 5; `team/conductor/rc1/BRIEF.md`.

> The title is a working title.

Leanpub shows its default cover until one is uploaded, and the designer is not staffed. The paperback's wrap needs the spine width, which comes from the final page count (publishing/cover_size.py); the new chapters will change that count.

- [ ] A: a plain typographic cover now (title, subtitle, your name) for Leanpub and Kindle; the paperback wrap last
- [ ] B: a cover built on one image from the day (the brakes slide, or a map)
- [ ] C: Leanpub's default until a designer is staffed
- [ ] Something else (below)

Recommended: A. It can be made quickly, changed when the title is signed, and it does not commit the book to an image before the maps are drawn.

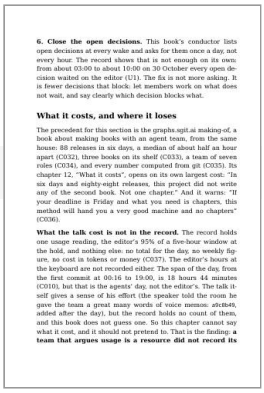
YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

DECISION

The Kindle price beside a free Leanpub floor

publisher-09

12-build-your-own.md, RC1 page 256



6. Close the open decisions. This book's conductor lists open decisions at every wake and asks for them once a day, not every hour. The record shows that is not enough on its own: from about 03:00 to about 10:00 on 30 October every open decision waited on the editor (U1). The fix is not more asking. It is fewer decisions that block: let members work on what does not wait, and say clearly which decision blocks what.

What it costs, and where it loses

The precedent for this section is the graphs.sgit.ai making-of, a book about making books with an agent team, from the same house: 88 releases in six days, a median of about half an hour apart (C032), three books on its shelf (C033), a team of seven roles (C034), and every number computed from git (C035). Its chapter 12, "What it costs", opens on its own largest cost: "In six days and eighty-eight releases, this project did not write any of the second book. Not one chapter." And it warns: "If your deadline is Friday and what you need is chapters, this method will hand you a very good machine and no chapters" (C036).

What the talk cost is not in the record. The record holds one usage reading, the editor's 95% of a five-hour window at the hold, and nothing else: no total for the day, no weekly figure, no cost in tokens or money (C037). The editor's hours at the keyboard are not recorded either. The span of the day, from the first commit at 00:16 to 19:00, is 18 hours 44 minutes (C010), but that is the agents' day, not the editor's. The talk itself gives a sense of his effort (the speaker told the room he gave the team a great many words of voice memos: afcfb49, added after the day), but the record holds no count of them, and this book does not guess one. So this chapter cannot say what it cost, and it should not pretend to. That is the feeling: **a team that argues usage is a resource did not record its**

> So this chapter cannot say what it cost, and it should not pretend to.

L1 is signed: a free minimum on Leanpub and the suggested price as proposed. Kindle comes next. KDP's pricing rules include a condition on the Kindle price against the book's price elsewhere, and Amazon can match a lower price it finds. The publisher has not yet read how KDP treats a Leanpub book whose minimum is free, and must, with the page cited, before submission.

- [ ] A: keep L1 as signed; Kindle at the suggested price, once KDP's terms are read and cited
- [ ] B: keep the free floor on Leanpub only until Web Summit, then a paid floor
- [ ] C: Kindle below the suggested price
- [ ] Something else (below)

Recommended: A, pending the check. Your free floor was a deliberate choice; it should change only if KDP's own terms say it must.

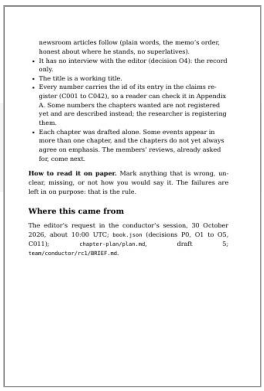
YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

DECISION

The ISBN, and who the publisher is

publisher-10

0-about-this-release-candidate.md, RC1 page 5



> Mark anything that is wrong, unclear, missing, or not how you would say it.

KDP.md leaves this to you. KDP's free ISBN is quick but names KDP as the publisher, and it covers that edition on Amazon only. Your own ISBN names you, or an imprint you choose, and travels with the book to a later publisher's edit.

- [ ] A: KDP's free ISBN, for speed
- [ ] B: your own ISBN, under your name or an imprint
- [ ] C: no ISBN for the ebook; decide for the paperback only
- [ ] Something else (below)

Recommended: B if you expect a town planner's edition elsewhere; otherwise A. Only you know which.

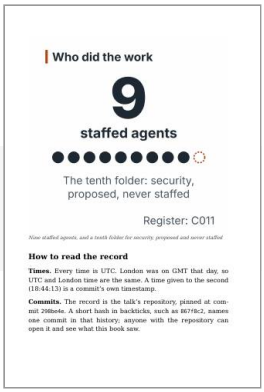
YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

QUESTION

What the paperback's QR codes point at

publisher-11

00-before-you-start.md, RC1 page 9



> A short hash in backticks, such as `867f8c2`, names one commit in that history; anyone with the repository can open it and see what this book saw.

book.json promises QR codes to the record in the paperback. A hash on paper is only useful if a reader can open it. Will the talk's repository stay public, with its history to 298be4e unchanged? Should the codes point at GitHub commit pages, or at the book's own site, which can survive a move? One code per chapter (beside 'Where this came from') or one per image?

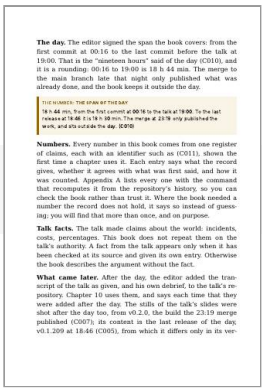
YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

RATIONALE

Why the sources stay at each chapter's end

publisher-12

00-before-you-start.md, RC1 page 10



> Appendix A lists every one with the command that recomputes it from the repository's history, so you can check the book rather than trust it.

In print, 'Where this came from' is a block of paths and hashes, and the usual move is to endnotes. The publisher keeps it at the end of each chapter, set smaller, because the book's own rule says every chapter ends with where it came from, and because checking the book rather than trusting it only works if the source is on the page the claim is on. A QR code beside it (see the QR item) gives the paper reader a way in.

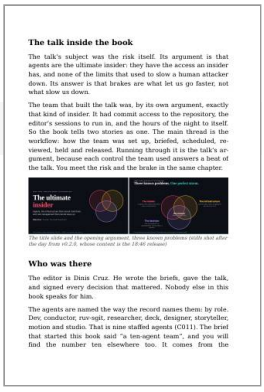
☐ AGREED ☐ NOT AGREED (NOTE BELOW)

DECISION

Back matter for the first edition

publisher-13

00-before-you-start.md, RC1 page 7



> The editor is Dinis Cruz.

Today the back matter is Appendix A alone. A first edition usually adds: about the author, in your voice and approved by you; the licence (CC BY, signed in Q5); a colophon on how the book was made (agents, Markua, the build); and a glossary, which the concept boxes can feed.

- ☐ A: all four for Leanpub day
- ☐ B: about the author and the licence for Leanpub day; colophon and glossary by Web Summit
- ☐ C: the licence only
- ☐ Something else (below)

Recommended: B. The bio and licence are needed on sale; the colophon and glossary are better once the plumbing chapter and concept boxes exist.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

COMMENT **The EPUB: commands, tables and alt text** publisher-14

99-appendix-a-every-number-rerun.md, RC1 page 284


Appendix A. Every number rerun

Every number in this book comes from one register, claims/register.json, and every entry in it carries a command that computes the number from the record. This appendix prints those commands with what they return, so that a reader can check the book without trusting it. The precedent is the making-of book on graphs.sqit.ai, whose own appendix carries the scripts behind every count in it (C035).

Every number, rerun

id	C006
value	18:44:13
state	checked
command	git log 298be4e

Read-only, pinned to the day's last commit

One register entry: an id, a value, a state and a read-only command pinned to the last commit

> This appendix prints those commands with what they return, so that a reader can check the book without trusting it.

KDP takes the EPUB, so it must pass EPUBCheck, which is not yet run. Three things to fix on the way: Appendix A's long commands and chapter 10's table will overflow a phone screen and need wrapping or a smaller code style; in Markua the bracket text of an image is read as its caption, so each image needs a separate alt text for readers who cannot see it (to be confirmed against the Markua 0.30 spec); and the captions are long sentences, better shortened for the small screen.

☐ AGREED ☐ NOT AGREED (NOTE BELOW)

The Gen ZX Founders team

a conductor sub-agent reading as the Gen ZX Founders book's team (not that team's own words)

> *RC1 already has what the Gen ZX book lacked for a long time: a reason to read on its second page, failures kept in, and every number traced. What it lacks is what your pen asked for there: maps taught first and drawn, terms explained where they first appear, the making-of out of the reader's way, and a voice that is yours. The ten decisions below are ordered by how much each would improve RC1 for you.*

DECISION

Teach Wardley maps first, simple to complex, and draw them

gen-zx-01

00-before-you-start.md, RC1 page 11

> The explorer builds something that has never existed, fast and by hand, and accepts that it will be rough.



sion number. Everything else is the record as it stood that night.

What this book is not

It is not a transcript. The record is large, much of it machine-written, and none of it meant to be read straight through. The book reads it with hindsight: what was achieved, in what order, why it worked, what it cost and what went wrong. It quotes the record as evidence, briefly, and spends its words on explanation.

It is not a celebration. The failures stay in: the hold that came before any of the talk's planned locks closed, the player that landed late, the correction that never reached its slide, the leaks a review caught after the push rather than before. A book about controls that left out where the controls missed would be making the very mistake the talk warns against.

And it is not a manual for attack. The insider argument is made entirely with this benign team, doing ordinary work in the open. The book describes risks, and the brakes that answered them; it never describes methods.

Explorer, villager, town planner

The editor names the stages of work the way he names the stages of any new thing. The explorer builds something that has never existed, fast and by hand, and accepts that it will be rough. The villager takes what the explorer found and makes it repeatable and usable by others. The town planner makes it industrial.

The day of the talk was the explorer's work. This edition is the villager's: the record turned into a book you can follow and a setup you can rebuild, written quickly and in the open, with its

The team's three stages arrive in chapter 0 with no map behind them, and the first map in the book is a screenshot in chapter 5. On the Gen ZX book your pen asked for exactly this order: draw a plain graph first, then add the evolution axis so position means something, then the cast as the settling of a new land. Each later part could then carry one map, rising in complexity, drawn from data by the team's own renderer.

- [ ] A: A short section at the end of chapter 0 that teaches maps in three steps, then one map per part
- [ ] B: A new short chapter straight after chapter 0 for the same sequence
- [ ] C: Keep maps where they are and add a two-sentence explanation at chapter 5
- [ ] Something else (below)

Recommended: A: it matches your own words this morning that maps must come much sooner, and keeps the opening short.

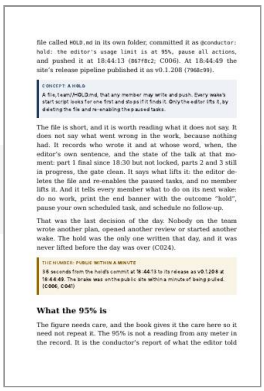
YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

DECISION

Explain every term where it first appears, and add a concepts part

gen-zx-02

01-pause-all-actions.md, RC1 page 30



> The figure needs care, and the book gives it the care here so it need not repeat it.

Chapter 1 uses wake, gate, hold, lock, banner and release before any is explained, and a reader who has never run an agent cannot follow the scene. On Gen ZX the first edition's concepts part stayed as outlines and never shipped; the second edition introduced ideas in the chapters and the pen still found gaps where an idea arrived one chapter late. The lesson is both: a sentence at first use, and a short, finished reference entry for each concept near the end.

- [ ] A: A plain sentence at first use, plus a finished concepts and principles part after chapter 12, ordered as the reader meets them, with an index
- [ ] B: Sentences at first use only, no separate part
- [ ] C: The part only, with chapters left as they are
- [ ] Something else (below)

Recommended: A: the sentence stops the reader stalling, and the part gives the analogy, the picture and the link the pen asked for. Every entry written whole, never as bullets.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

DECISION

Write the plumbing and the years behind the day, as a decision first

gen-zx-03



2. Midnight, an empty repository

At 00:16:23 on 29 October 2026 the editor created a repository (C001). It held a licence, a short README and Python's standard list of files to ignore. Nothing else happened in it for twenty-four minutes. By that evening a team of agents would be holding itself still so that its editor could give a talk; at a quarter past midnight there was no team, no talk, no site and no rule. This chapter is about what went into the empty repository first, in what order, and why the order matters more than any single thing in it.

The short answer is that the first thing to arrive was not a team. It was a brief, a place to keep what is true, a place to keep what the brief got wrong, and a gate. The team came after; and it came into a house whose walls were already standing.

One commit, the whole first pass

At 00:40:50 a single session committed the first pass of the site and the talk (1f7c633). Its message lists what it carried: the editor's brief published in full, a reality file and a corrections file, one build script, a gate, a release pipeline that owns the version number, the talk as data with its slides on one engine, a keyboard player with a presenter view, the first article, and one role file, team/dev/ROLE.md, for dev@the-ultimate-insider. The register gives this as dev's first commit (C011). Four minutes later, at 00:45:02, the pipeline released it as v0.1.0 (a609186).

02-midnight-an-empty-repository.md, RC1 page 43

> At 00:40:50 a single session committed the first pass of the site and the talk (`1f7c633`).

You asked for the plumbing, the quality and workflow machinery, and the work that met on the day. RC1 has none of it, and the book's current rule is that it uses the record of the day only. The history is not in that record, so this needs your signature before anything is written. On Gen ZX the same story worked when told as what each piece made possible, and was criticised when it read as a list of one person's products.

- [ ] A: Sign a new section after chapter 2, from your published articles, cited, with any number registered first
- [ ] B: Put it in a closing chapter or appendix so the day stays the spine
- [ ] C: Leave it out of this book and cover it in an article
- [ ] Something else (below)

Recommended: A, told as what each piece made possible on the day, with a map of the pieces moving from new to commodity. Not a product list.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

DECISION

Move the making-of back and call RC1 a release

gen-zx-04



About this release candidate

This is RC1, the release candidate of the book of The Ultimate Insider, first made on Friday 30 October 2026 for the editor to read on paper. There will not be a long series of candidates. RC1 is revised in place, from the editor's notes and the team's reviews, until it is the first edition. It is a release, to be read as finished; where something is not done yet, it says so on every count.

What it is. Thirteen chapters and an appendix, drafted in one morning from the plan the editor signed at about 10:00 UTC (the storyteller's draft 5), at his word: "use the judgement of the team". No writer was staffed, so the conductor drafted it with sub-agents, one or two chapters each, from the record: the talk's repository up to 29bbeie, the cleaned transcript added after the day (a9c0849), the book team's index, timeline, control register and claims register, and the Cold-Read team's finished findings.

Added the same morning, at the editor's word. After his principles of about 10:30 UTC: a chapter on how to read a Wardley map (after chapter 0), sixteen maps from the simplest to the day's controls, a chapter on what was already there (the plumbing, and the public work of the years before the day; its dates are still being registered), a part on concepts and principles after chapter 12, a first pass of infographics and call-outs, and a cover. A corrections pass then fixed what the members' reviews found, the leak account first. A companion volume carries every question, comment and decision for the editor, with a box to tick.

What it is not, yet.

- It is written about the editor, in the third person. A revision of RC1 moves it into his voice, first person, by the rules his

0-about-this-release-candidate.md, RC1 page 4

> It is a release, to be read as finished; where something is not done yet, it says so on every count.

The first pages the reader meets are all how the book was made, the page your pen struck on the Gen ZX candidate. That book also learned to say it is a release, not a draft, and to talk to the reader, never to the editor. Its answer was two editions of every candidate: a release edition with nothing draft in it, and a reviewer edition with the notes, questions and answer spaces.

- [ ] A: Two editions: release edition with the making-of at the end, reviewer edition with notes and questions
- [ ] B: One edition, making-of moved to the end, wording changed from draft to first release
- [ ] C: Leave the page where it is
- [ ] Something else (below)

Done in this RC1: Partly: the about page now calls RC1 a release to be read as finished; moving the making-of back is still the editor's decision.

Recommended: A, the same decision you took on the other book. Move the reading guide from chapter 0 to the head of Appendix A.

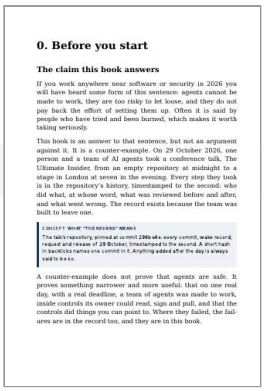
YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

DECISION

Make the opening a best of, and group chapters into parts

gen-zx-05

00-before-you-start.md, RC1 page 6



0. Before you start

The claim this book answers

If you work anywhere near software or security in 2026 you will have heard some form of this sentence: agents cannot be made to work, they are too risky to let loose, and they do not pay back the effort of setting them up. Often it is said by people who have tried and been burned, which makes it worth taking seriously.

This book is an answer to that sentence, but not an argument against it. It is a counter-example. On 29 October 2026, one person and a team of AI agents took a conference talk, The Ultimate Insider, from an empty repository at midnight to a stage in London at seven in the evening. Every step they took is in the repository's history, timestamped to the second: who did what, at whose word, what was reviewed before and after, and what went wrong. The record exists because the team was built to leave one.

> CONCEPT: WHAT "THE RECORD" MEANS
> The talk's repository, pinned at commit 2986 e4c every commit, make record, request and release of 29 October, timestamped to the second. A short hash in backticks names one commit in it. Anything added after the day's always said to be so.

A counter-example does not prove that agents are safe. It proves something narrower and more useful: that on one real day, with a real deadline, a team of agents was made to work, inside controls its owner could read, sign and pull, and that the controls did things you can point to. Where they failed, the failures are in the record too, and they are in this book.

> This book is an answer to that sentence, but not an argument against it.

Chapter 0 already gives a reason to read by its second page, which the Gen ZX candidate did not manage until much later. It could go further: say what the reader will hold at each milestone, point to the site with a QR code, and show the contents as a picture. Grouping the chapters into four or five parts, each opened with a picture, gives the reader milestones instead of one finish line.

- [ ] A: Add milestones, a site pointer with QR code, a contents picture, and four or five parts with picture openers
- [ ] B: Milestones and the site pointer only, no parts
- [ ] C: No change to the structure
- [ ] Something else (below)

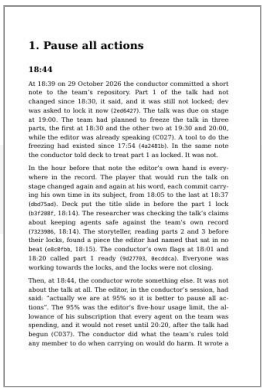
Recommended: A: it follows your zoom-in rule that every step of attention buys the next.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

DECISION

Draw the structures, by code, at every altitude

gen-zx-06



1. Pause all actions

18:44

At 18:39 on 29 October 2026 the conductor committed a short note to the team's repository. Part 1 of the talk had not changed since 18:30, it said, and it was still not locked; dev was asked to lock it now (2ed6627). The talk was due on stage at 19:00. The team had planned to freeze the talk in three parts, the first at 18:30 and the other two at 19:30 and 20:00, while the editor was already speaking (C027). A tool to do the freezing had existed since 17:54 (4a2481b). In the same note the conductor told deck to treat part 1 as locked. It was not.

In the hour before that note the editor's own hand is everywhere in the record. The player that would run the talk on stage changed again and again at his word, each commit carrying his own time in its subject, from 18:05 to the last at 18:37 (dbd75a0). Deck put the title slide in before the part 1 lock (b3f288f, 18:14). The researcher was checking the talk's claims about keeping agents safe against the team's own record (7323986, 18:14). The storyteller, reading parts 2 and 3 before their locks, found a piece the editor had named that sat in no beat (a8c49da, 18:15). The conductor's own flags at 18:01 and 18:20 called part 1 ready (9d27703, 8ecd4ca). Everyone was working towards the locks, and the locks were not closing.

Then, at 18:44, the conductor wrote something else. It was not about the talk at all. The editor, in the conductor's session, had said: "actually we are at 95% so it is better to pause all actions". The 95% was the editor's five-hour usage limit, the allowance of his subscription that every agent on the team was spending, and it would not reset until 20:20, after the talk had begun (C037). The conductor did what the team's rules told any member to do when carrying on would do harm. It wrote a

01-pause-all-actions.md, RC1 page 29

> At 18:39 on 29 October 2026 the conductor committed a short note to the team's repository.

The book has stills of the day and no drawn infographic. Drawn from data, a figure stays correct when the text changes and every label can be checked against its source. The candidates are the day's turning points as a timeline, the empty house's founding files, the old insider against the agent, reach, mandate, gap and barrier, the barrier ladder, the schedule as a clock, the five-step wake as a cycle, the story of one figure as a timeline, the hand-back and the colliding brakes.

- [ ] A: Accept a plan of drawn figures at four altitudes, each accepted by you in the browser before it enters a chapter
- [ ] B: Draw only the timeline, the wake cycle and the barrier ladder for now
- [ ] C: Keep screenshots only
- [ ] Something else (below)

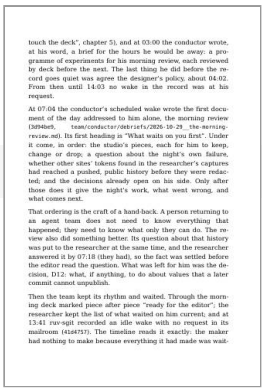
Recommended: A, proposed in a plan you can accept or decline item by item. The Gen ZX figure on reach, mandate, gap and barrier can be redrawn here, credited.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

DECISION

Move into your voice, starting with the chapter about you

gen-zx-07



06-the-editor-signs.md, RC1 page 123

> That ordering is the craft of a hand-back.

The chapter about you reads strangest in the third person, and it is where your own read, comment, decide loop belongs: the same principle you used on another book, and the reason this team asks instead of guessing. When the voice moves, your pen notes on the other book set the rules: nothing harsh, no hedges, no self-validation by where you first said something, and no book talking about itself.

- [ ] A: First person throughout, chapter 6 first
- [ ] B: First person for the opening, the close and the principles; record chapters stay third person
- [ ] C: Keep third person with a foreword in your voice
- [ ] Something else (below)

Recommended: B for the next revision, starting with chapter 6, then A once you have read it. This overlaps the conductor's own question on voice.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

DECISION

Thin the record out of the prose

gen-zx-08



02-midnight-an-empty-repository.md, RC1 page 43

> Four minutes later, at 00:45:02, the pipeline released it as v0.1.0 (`ab09186`).

Commit hashes, file paths and second-precise times arrive at a density no general reader can follow. Keep the register ids, which are your fact marker, and explain them once. Move most hashes and paths into each chapter's closing note on where it came from, or behind a QR code to the commit on the site. Runs of numbers become small charts, and the space freed pays for the maps, concepts and plumbing.

- [ ] A: Keep ids in the prose, move hashes, paths and exact times to the closing notes or a QR code
- [ ] B: Thin only chapters 1 and 2, where the density is worst
- [ ] C: Leave the record in the prose
- [ ] Something else (below)

Recommended: A: the reader keeps the proof without carrying it, and the book stays near its planned length.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

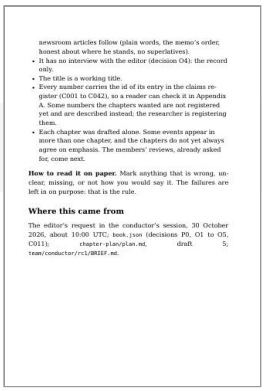
QUESTION

Ready for your pen on the plane?

gen-zx-09

0-about-this-release-candidate.md, RC1 page 5

> Mark anything that is wrong, unclear, missing, or not how you would say it.



newsroom articles follow (plain words, the memo's order, honest about where he stands, no superlatives).

- It has no interview with the editor (decision O4): the record only.
- The title is a working title.
- Every number carries the id of its entry in the claims register (C001 to C042), so a reader can check it in Appendix A. Some numbers the chapters wanted are not registered yet and are described instead; the researcher is registering them.
- Each chapter was drafted alone. Some events appear in more than one chapter, and the chapters do not yet always agree on emphasis. The members' reviews, already asked for, come next.

How to read it on paper. Mark anything that is wrong, unclear, missing, or not how you would say it. The failures are left in on purpose: that is the rule.

Where this came from

The editor's request in the conductor's session, 30 October 2026, about 10:00 UTC; `book.json` (decisions P0, O1 to O5, C011); `chapter-plan/plan.md`, draft 5; `team/conductor/rc1/BRIEF.md`.

That sentence is addressed to you, not to the reader. When you print RC1 and mark it, the Gen ZX intake can be reused: each photographed page read note by note, uncertain readings confirmed with you, each note given a page and number id, grouped into themes, and each given one of your verbs (keep, fix, rewrite, merge, cut, later, not doing it) as a decision file. The same workflow can then be recommended to the reader. Do you want it set up now, and with which verbs?

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

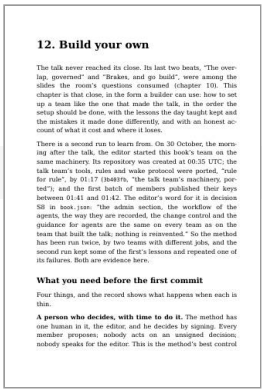
DECISION

Run synthetic readers, then propose a cover

gen-zx-10

12-build-your-own.md, RC1 page 242

> There is a second run to learn from.



12. Build your own

The talk never reached its close. Its last two beats, "The overlap, governed" and "Brakes, and go build", were among the slides the room's questions consumed (chapter 10). This chapter is that close, in the form a builder can use: how to set up a team like the one that made the talk, in the order the setup should be done, with the lessons the day taught kept and the mistakes it made done differently, and with an honest account of what it cost and where it loses.

There is a second run to learn from. On 30 October, the morning after the talk, the editor started this book's team on the same machinery. Its repository was created at 00:35 UTC; the talk team's tools, rules and wake protocol were ported, "rule for rule", by 01:17 (1b4937b, "the talk team's machinery, ported"), and the first batch of members published their keys between 01:41 and 01:42. The editor's word for it is decision S8 in `book.jsn`: "the admin section, the workflow of the agents, the way they are recorded, the change control and the guidance for agents are the same on every team as on the team that built the talk; nothing is reinvented." So the method has been run twice, by two teams with different jobs, and the second run kept none of the first's lessons and repeated one of its failures. Both are evidence here.

What you need before the first commit

Four things, and the record shows what happens when each is thin.

A person who decides, with time to do it. The method has one human in it, the editor, and he decides by signing. Every member proposes; nobody acts on an unsigned decision; nobody speaks for the editor. This is the method's best control

Before the next printing, a small panel of invented readers could read the frozen text in print order and say where they would put the book down and whether they would buy it. Their journeys are written down before the runs, and every quote is checked word for word. Covers drawn by code could follow, with two gates: the title readable as a thumbnail, and nothing in the barcode area. Both are proposals, never chosen for you.

- [ ] A: Panel of five readers, then three covers drawn by code for your choice
- [ ] B: Readers only, covers later
- [ ] C: Neither for now
- [ ] Something else (below)

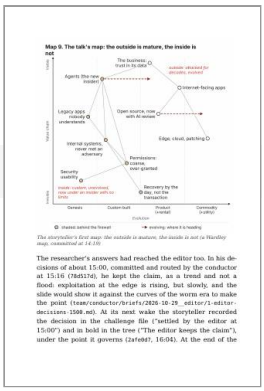
Recommended: A, in that order: the readers will tell you where the book is slowest before you spend time on a cover.

YOUR ANSWER OR NOTE

COMMENT

Caution: drawings must survive a black and white printer

gen-zx-11



05-the-story-before-the-slides.md, RC1 page 106

> The researcher's answers had reached the editor too.

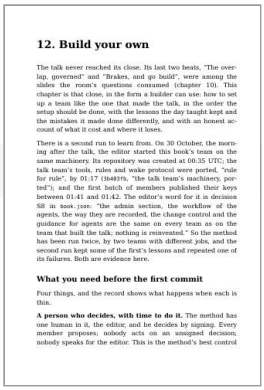
Your paper review will be printed in black and white. The map renderer draws movement as a red arrow and shades the firewall in pale blue, and on a mono printer both may vanish. Give the arrow a shape, such as a dashed line with a head, and mark bands with a hatch or a label, so shape, position and text carry the meaning without colour.

☐ AGREED ☐ NOT AGREED (NOTE BELOW)

COMMENT

Caution: new material must be paid for with cuts

gen-zx-12



12-build-your-own.md, RC1 page 242

> There is a second run to learn from.

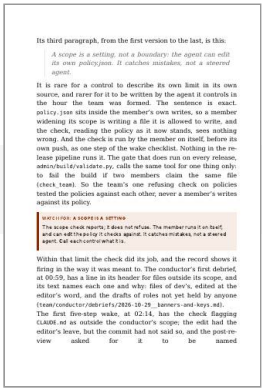
RC1 is already a little over its planned length. Gen ZX went from a tight first candidate to one its own readers and editor called too long, and cutting turned out easier than filling. Maps, concepts and plumbing are worth adding, but each addition should be paid for by cutting record detail, and the cuts are yours to choose.

☐ AGREED ☐ NOT AGREED (NOTE BELOW)

COMMENT

What works: the strongest chapter, keep it

gen-zx-13



03-a-mandate-you-can-read.md, RC1 page 68

> A scope is a setting, not a boundary: the agent can edit its own policy.json.

Quoting the tool's own admission is a gift, and the reach, mandate and gap argument is clear. This is the chapter to build the barrier ladder and the reach picture around. It would gain most from one plain sentence on what an Agent Behaviour Policy is, with an analogy such as a job description against the keys to the building.

☐ AGREED ☐ NOT AGREED (NOTE BELOW)

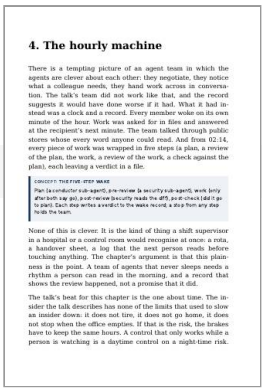
COMMENT **What works: the shift supervisor opening and the honest ledger**

gen-zx-14

04-the-hourly-machine.md, RC1 page 81

> None of this is clever.

The opening is the short, clear analogy you asked for on the other book, and the form is worth reusing for every machine chapter. The failures kept in, the register ids and the appendix that reruns every number already answer your fact-or-opinion request better than the Gen ZX book ever did. Keep them while the changes above land.



4. The hourly machine

There is a tempting picture of an agent team in which the agents are clever about each other: they negotiate, they notice what a colleague needs, they hand work across in conversation. The talk's team did not work like that, and the record suggests it would have done worse if it had. What it had instead was a clock and a record. Every member woke on its own minute of the hour. Work was asked for in files and answered at the recipient's next minute. The team talked through public stores whose every word anyone could read. And from 02:14, every piece of work was wrapped in five steps (a plan, a review of the plan, the work, a review of the work, a check against the plan), each leaving a verdict in a file.

CONCEPT: THE FIVE-STEP WAKE

Plan (a conductor sub-agent), pre-review (a security sub-agent), work (only after both say go), post-review (security reads the diff), post-check (did it go to plan). Each step writes a verdict to the wake record, a stop from any step holds the team.

None of this is clever. It is the kind of thing a shift supervisor in a hospital or a control room would recognise at once: a rota, a handover sheet, a log that the next person reads before touching anything. The chapter's argument is that this plainness is the point. A team of agents that never sleeps needs a rhythm a person can read in the morning, and a record that shows the review happened, not a promise that it did.

The talk's best for this chapter is the one about time. The insider the talk describes has none of the limits that used to slow an insider down: it does not tire, it does not go home, it does not stop when the office empties. If that is the risk, the brakes have to keep the same hours. A control that only works while a person is watching is a daytime control on a night-time risk.

☐ AGREED ☐ NOT AGREED (NOTE BELOW)

Every decision on one sheet

CARD	FROM	DECISION	RC1 PAGE	DONE
conductor-01	The conductor	Move the whole book into your first-person voice	4	☐
conductor-02	The conductor	Title and subtitle	5	☐
conductor-03	The conductor	Where the Wardley maps come in	6	☐
conductor-04	The conductor	The plumbing and the two and a half years	217	☐
conductor-09	The conductor	When RC1 goes on Leanpub	4	☐
storyteller-01	The storyteller	Where the reader first learns to read a map	102	☐
storyteller-03	The storyteller	Where the two and a half years go	43	☐
storyteller-04	The storyteller	The principles section, and the last page	262	☐
storyteller-05	The storyteller	How far into your first person the book goes	118	☐
storyteller-07	The storyteller	Chapters 1 and 11 disagree on what kept it safe	40	☐
storyteller-08	The storyteller	The hold is told twice, in chapters 1 and 8	151	☐
storyteller-09	The storyteller	Chapter 9 reads like the register it cites	170	☐
storyteller-11	The storyteller	The book opens three times before the hold	6	☐
storyteller-12	The storyteller	Which titles go to the readers	6	☐
historian-03	The historian	One meaning of 'joined' for the whole book	248	☐
historian-07	The historian	State how long the talk ran, from the transcript?	193	☐
historian-08	The historian	Your own transcripts behind the key quotations	122	☐
historian-12	The historian	Turning points in the day's order	37	☐
librarian-01	The librarian	Cold-Read numbers have no register ids	216	☐
librarian-02	The librarian	Pin and label every Cold-Read citation	205	☐
librarian-03	The librarian	Under what licence do the images print?	189	☐
librarian-04	The librarian	Quoting the room and the host	198	☐
librarian-10	The librarian	The talk team's vaults: inside or outside the record?	86	☐
researcher-01	The researcher	The Cold-Read team's numbers need register entries	208	☐
researcher-03	The researcher	Count merges by their parents, not their subjects	213	☐
researcher-04	The researcher	C011's join times mix two methods	74	☐
researcher-07	The researcher	Chapter 12's cost: your figure, or its absence	256	☐
researcher-10	The researcher	Register the talk's length and the spoken claims	193	☐
security-02	Security	Fix the key tool before the book describes it	211	☐
security-05	Security	Settle D12 before the book points at the vault	130	☐
security-06	Security	One sentence on keys reads as a route	180	☐
security-09	Security	Is the Cold-Read team closed for good?	215	☐
security-11	Security	Who reviews changes to admin/tools/?	176	☐

security-12	Security	Rename the control ids before the revision	172	☐
publisher-01	The publisher	Moving RC1 into manuscript, and your merge to main	4	☐
publisher-02	The publisher	Three front notes, one book	4	☐
publisher-03	The publisher	Chapter numbers will move; the prose should not break	78	☐
publisher-04	The publisher	Colour images in a black-ink paperback	186	☐
publisher-06	The publisher	What Markua asides are for	81	☐
publisher-07	The publisher	Infographics, and who draws them	37	☐
publisher-08	The publisher	A cover before the title is signed	5	☐
publisher-09	The publisher	The Kindle price beside a free Leanpub floor	256	☐
publisher-10	The publisher	The ISBN, and who the publisher is	5	☐
publisher-13	The publisher	Back matter for the first edition	7	☐
gen-zx-01	The Gen ZX Founders team	Teach Wardley maps first, simple to complex, and draw them	11	☐
gen-zx-02	The Gen ZX Founders team	Explain every term where it first appears, and add a concepts part	30	☐
gen-zx-03	The Gen ZX Founders team	Write the plumbing and the years behind the day, as a decision first	43	☐
gen-zx-04	The Gen ZX Founders team	Move the making-of back and call RC1 a release	4	☐
gen-zx-05	The Gen ZX Founders team	Make the opening a best of, and group chapters into parts	6	☐
gen-zx-06	The Gen ZX Founders team	Draw the structures, by code, at every altitude	29	☐
gen-zx-07	The Gen ZX Founders team	Move into your voice, starting with the chapter about you	123	☐
gen-zx-08	The Gen ZX Founders team	Thin the record out of the prose	43	☐
gen-zx-10	The Gen ZX Founders team	Run synthetic readers, then propose a cover	242	☐

Made from team/conductor/rc1/annotations/ in the book repository; the cards and RC1 are both release candidate 1.